



Process liquor sales at a bar facility

D1.HBS.CL5.08

Trainee Manual



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& hospitality

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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Process liquor sales at a bar facility

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Process liquor sales at a bar facility in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HBS.CL5.08

Nominal Hours:

30

Element 1: Complete liquor sales

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Provide advice or information to customers on different types of products available
- 1.2 Process sales promptly in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 1.3 Complete order forms, invoices and/or receipts accurately in accordance with enterprise and legal requirements
- 1.4 Operate point of sale equipment in accordance with manufacturer's instructions
- 1.5 Ensure all necessary material and/or consumables are available at the point of sale area
- 1.6 Maintain cash drawer and float in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 1.7 Record transactions in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 1.8 Follow security procedures in accordance with enterprise requirements

Element 2: Pack goods

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Maintain adequate supplies of wrapping materials
- 2.2 Pack goods in a suitably sized bag or container that adequately protects the goods, or wrap goods neatly and effectively
- 2.3 Follow safe work practices while packing goods

Element 3: Minimise theft

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Apply security procedures to minimise theft
- 3.2 Maintain security of cash in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 3.3 Deal with suspicious behaviour of customers and/or staff in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 3.4 Keep storage areas secure from unauthorised access in accordance with enterprise procedures

Element 4: Merchandise goods

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Receive, unpack and store goods in appropriate location
- 4.2 Display stock in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 4.3 Create and/or dismantle special promotional displays
- 4.4 Keep displays clean and tidy
- 4.5 Rotate stock in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 4.6 Prepare labels and tickets in accordance with enterprise procedures
- 4.7 Ensure stock is correctly priced

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Complete liquor sales				
1.1	Provide advice or information to customers on different types of products available	1.1	1,2	1
1.2	Process sales promptly in accordance with enterprise procedures	1.2	3	2
1.3	Complete order forms, invoices and/or receipts accurately in accordance with enterprise and legal requirements	1.3	4	3
1.4	Operate point of sale equipment in accordance with manufacturer's instructions	1.4	5,6	4
1.5	Ensure all necessary material and/or consumables are available at the point of sale area	1.5	7	5
1.6	Maintain cash drawer and float in accordance with enterprise procedures	1.6	8	6
1.7	Record transactions in accordance with enterprise procedures	1.7	9	7
1.8	Follow security procedures in accordance with enterprise requirements	1.8	10	8
Element 2: Pack goods				
2.1	Maintain adequate supplies of wrapping materials	2.1	11	9
2.2	Pack goods in a suitably sized bag or container that adequately protects the goods, or wrap goods neatly and effectively	2.2	12	10
2.3	Follow safe work practices while packing goods	2.3	13	11

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 3: Minimise theft				
3.1	Apply security procedures to minimise theft	3.1	14	12
3.2	Maintain security of cash in accordance with enterprise procedures	3.2	15,16	13
3.3	Deal with suspicious behaviour of customers and/or staff in accordance with enterprise procedures	3.3	17,18	14
3.4	Keep storage areas secure from unauthorised access in accordance with enterprise procedures	3.4	19	15
Element 4: Merchandise goods				
4.1	Receive, unpack and store goods in appropriate location	4.1	20,21	16
4.2	Display stock in accordance with enterprise procedures	4.2	22,23	17
4.3	Create and/or dismantle special promotional displays	4.3	24	18
4.4	Keep displays clean and tidy	4.4	25,26	19
4.5	Rotate stock in accordance with enterprise procedures	4.5	27,28	20
4.6	Prepare labels and tickets in accordance with enterprise procedures	4.6	29	21
4.7	Ensure stock is correctly priced	4.7	30	22

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Ancillary products	Products to supplement the liquor products
Bar code	A series of lines of varying width, printed, as on a container or product, that can be read by an optical scanner to determine charges for purchases
Cash float	An amount of money that an establishment has deemed appropriate to commence the day's trading for a cash register or point-of-sale (POS) terminal.
Convenience foods	Pre-prepared and packages items for quick and simple use or consumption
Documentation	Written records used to identify an activity or sale
EFTPOS	Electronic Funds Transfer at Point Of Sale
Gift wrapping	To improve the appearance of a purchased product
'Generic' wine	Wines that are made to a particular style
House	Organisation
Internal	Policies and procedures linked to an establishment
Invoices	Written account for goods purchased
Liqueurs	Spirits that have been flavoured with fruits, herbs, roots and plants, sweetened and sometimes artificially coloured
Liquor	Alcoholic beverages
Merchandise	The stock of goods in a store
OSH	Occupational safety and health
Order forms	Used to formalise and standardise orders placed by customers
Pilferage	The act of petty theft
POS equipment	Point of Sale equipment

Term	Explanation
'Proof'	Way of indicating the alcoholic strength of drinks.
Surveillance	To watch with close intent
Theft	The act of stealing; the wrongful taking and carrying away of the personal goods or property of another
Transaction	A record of a purchase and or payment for a product
'Varietal' wine	wines made from one grape variety

Element 1: Complete liquor sales

1.1 Provide advice or information to customers on different types of products available

Introduction

Retail liquor outlets can offer a wide variety of liquor and non-liquor products for sale.

When advising customers on their purchases the two keys are to:

- Identify customer needs and preferences – listen to what they say and ask questions to determine exact requirements
- Use product knowledge – to match products to these identified needs and preferences.



What sort of information do I need to know?

The type of general information you may need to pass on to customers includes:

- Products available
- Price of products
- Relative prices of similar products
- Origin of products
- Identifying products produced in the local region/origin
- Value for money
- Special promotions
- Ingredients
- Relative strength
- Suitable alternatives.



Ways to develop product knowledge

The following will provide an overview of these products. Everyone working in a liquor store should develop their product knowledge by:

- Read product labels
- Talk to sales representatives, suppliers, wineries, etc.
- Read relevant books on wines, spirits, etc.
- Read industry magazines containing articles and reviews on products



- Taste the products
- Talk to customers and get their feedback
- Attend and participate in tastings.

Products in a liquor outlet

Whilst every liquor venue will offer different products, common products that may be offered in a liquor outlet can include:

- Commonly stocked beers
- Wines
- Spirits
- Liqueurs
- Packaged convenience foods
- Non-alcoholic drinks.



This section will explore in detail some of the items within these common product types.

Beer

Beer is available in draught and packaged form.

Draught beer is beer that is drawn through the tap from barrels or kegs.

Packaged beer is beer that comes in bottles, cans or stubbies.

Beer Production

Beer is made by a process known as 'brewing'.

Precise times, temperatures and yeast type vary between breweries and brews.

The major production steps are:

- Barley is steeped in water and germinates.
- It is dried by warm air and ground in the brew house
- It is then mixed with water to make a liquid called 'wort'. The wort is then cooled and the yeast added to start the fermentation process
- The beer is then clarified, stored and matured
- Finally it is filtered, packaged and despatched for consumption.



Boutique beer

A boutique beer is a beer that is not mass produced.

It is usually made by a small operator such as a pub brewer, sometimes referred to as a micro-brewer.

Boutique beers may be domestic or international, with many boutique beers only being available in the premises where they were brewed, while others enjoy national exposure.

The range of beers is extremely diverse in these boutique operations with brewers demonstrating their creativity and ability to produce unique and outstanding tastes.

Local beers

Each country will have its own specialty beers that are often the most popular and consumed in the greatest amount.

These many be in draught or packaged form.

Imported beers

Most food and beverage establishments, especially international hotels provide a range of beers from different countries around the world. These are normally in packaged form.

Popular imported beers include:

- Fosters - Australia
- Lowenbrau – Germany
- Beck's – Germany
- Fürstenburg – Germany
- König Pilsener – Germany
- Corona – Mexico
- Budweiser – USA
- Hollandia – Holland
- Heineken – Holland
- Miller – USA
- Maes – Belgium
- Chimay – Belgium
- Duvel – Belgium
- Asahi – Japan.



Even though international beers may be brewed in local countries, this does not prevent importation of beers that were brewed overseas in the country of origin of the beer.

Beer variations

Most beer is consumed 'neat' but some people prefer to add a little something to their beer, in order to get a different taste.

Beer variations include:

- Shandy – Beer and lemonade
- Beer with a dash – Beer with a dash of lemonade
- Lager and lime – Lager with a dash of lime juice
- Red eye beer – with tomato juice
- Black and tan – Beer and stout

- Half and half – Beer and stout (can also refer to black beer and blonde beer)
- Portergaff – Stout and lemonade
- Stout with a dash – Stout with a dash of lemonade.

Wine

Wine is defined as the naturally produced beverage made from the fermented juice of grapes.

Wine is a major aspect of beverage service and is routinely served to complement a lunch or evening meal.

Wine categories

Wine can be categorised as follows:

- Varietal or generic
- Sparkling
- Fortified.



Varietal wines

'Varietal' wines are wines made from one grape variety. The name of this grape appears on the label of the bottle.

Where a wine claims that the wine is made from a certain grape variety, the wine must be made from a minimum 85% of that stated variety.

Where a wine claims to be made from grapes of a certain year, then 85% of the wine must be from that specified year.

Where a wine claims that the wine comes from a nominated region, then 85% of the wine must come from that stated area.



Varietal white wines

White grape varieties include:

- Chardonnay – a full-flavoured dry white wine
- Chenin Blanc – a pleasant fruity 'drink now' wine with a refreshing acid finish
- Rhine Riesling – a delicate wine with fruit character and a trace of sugar that varies hugely depending on the region in which it is grown. Common flavour citrus – lime or lemon.
- Sauvignon Blanc – a dry white wine with distinct varietal flavour such as melon, pineapple, tropical fruit
- Semillon – a dry, crisp white wine with grassy flavours
- Traminer – a fresh and fruity wine with a spicy smell and taste.

The common bottle size for most white wines is 750 ml.



Varietal red wines

Red grape varieties include:

- Cabernet Sauvignon – an aromatic red with berry, mint, capsicum and blackcurrant highlights
- Malbec – a fruity, soft wine
- Merlot – another fruity and aromatic red reminiscent of plums, pumpkins and fruitcake
- Pinot Noir – a lighter style red, thin in taste and colour, berry flavours
- Shiraz – this grape produces fine full-flavoured reds that vary greatly from region to region. They are often blended and may have peppery characteristics.



Generic wines

'Generic' is the term used to describe wines are made to a style, usually naming a European location as its origin, such as Hock, Moselle, Claret and Burgundy.

Generic white wines

Generic white wines include:

- Chablis – a very dry, flinty wine
- Hock – a very dry white wine
- Moselle – a popular and pleasantly semi-sweet wine, less sweet than Sauternes
- Sauternes – produced from fully ripe grapes, a very sweet wine
- White Burgundy – a fairly dry white with full flavour.

Generic red wines

Generic red wines include:

- Burgundy – a soft and fruity red wine
- Claret – a dry red with more astringency than burgundy.

When most wine industries started, most if not all of their wines were generic wines.

Today there is a tendency for the cask or house wines to be generic and the premium bottled wines to be varietal. That said, there are many types of varietal and blended cask wine.



Blended wines

Blended wines, as the name suggests are made from two or more grape varieties.

This may be done by a wine maker to create a unique taste:

- To mask a deficiency in one grape - such as lack of colour, lack of flavour
- Because of economic necessity - some grape varieties are cheaper than others.

A blended wine is not to be seen as inferior to a straight varietal wine. It is just different.

Cask wines

Many venues will use cask wine for their house wines. House wines are wines that are served by the glass or the carafe.

Glass sizes vary between 160 ml – 200 ml in size, and carafes are available in 500 ml, 1 litre and 2 litre.

Casks are available in a wide variety of varietal and generic options. Common sizes are 2 litres and 4 litres with some larger sizes including 10 litres and 20 litres.



Sparkling wines

The word 'Champagne' is now legally reserved for sparkling wine produced from the Champagne region in France. Where produced in other parts of the world, it is correctly now known as 'sparkling wine'.

Sparkling wines may be made using one of four options, each producing vastly different quality products.

Naturally carbonated wine

The traditional way of producing sparkling wine is using the French method known as 'méthode champenoise', whereby bubbles naturally occur in the bottle as a result the fermentation process.

Many sparkling wines are made using this process and highly regarded around the world as outstanding of the champagne style even though they are not by strict definition 'champagne'.

This method is also called 'méthode traditionnelle', or 'méthode classique'.



Carbonated or Injection method

This is the cheapest and quickest method and the one producing the lowest quality sparkling wine.

The base wine is placed in a closed tank and chilled. Carbon dioxide is pumped in under pressure and absorbed into wine. Cola and lemonade is made in the same way.

This method produces wine with comparatively large bubbles that disappear quickly in the glass. The label on this wine states 'Carbonated wine'.



Cuvee close, Charmat, Bulk or Tank method

The base wine is pumped into stainless steel tanks, where yeast and sugar is added to start a second fermentation. The first fermentation has happened to get the initial base wine. It is this second fermentation that puts the bubbles in the wine.

The wine is allowed to settle, is then filtered and transferred to another tank, still under pressure – where it receives a dose of sweetener or liqueur for the desired level of sweetness.

Transfer method

This represents a compromise between the Charmat method and the best, most expensive and most time-consuming method – méthode champenoise.

The secondary fermentation takes place in the bottle in the méthode champenoise way, and wines are also aged for a short while in the bottle.

The wine is transferred under pressure from bottles, after the secondary fermentation to tanks where it is allowed to settle and is filtered. A sweetener is added while the wine is still under pressure and then it is bottled for sale.

The label will state 'fermented in the bottle'.



Styles of champagne

Non-vintage (N.V.)

This is the most common style and is made from base of two to three wines every year to enable consistency of product.

The end product cannot be legally identified as coming from a specified year, hence the term N.V.



Vintage

This is a rarer and more expensive wine made solely from wine of the one nominated year.

It is usually a better quality champagne.

Vintage champagne not made every year. It depends on grape quality and the season.

Rosé

This style may be made from leaving the grape juice in contact with the red/black grapes for a period so the wine can pick up some colour from the skins or some red wine may be added, white base wine prior to the second fermentation.



Crémant

'Crémant' means 'creaming'.

The wine is a gently sparkling wine, giving the impression of creaminess, preferred by many especially with desserts.

Blanc de blancs

This wine is made exclusively from white grapes.

Blanc de Noirs

This wine is made only from red grapes.

Degrees of sweetness/dryness

Sugar levels vary between brands so a brut in one brand may well not be as dry as a brut in another.

The following is a general guide to sweetness/dryness:

- Driest - Extra brut
- Brut
- Extra dry
- Sec
- Demi-sec
- Sweetest - Doux.

Champagne will improve in bottle for a reasonable time.

It should be chilled before serving, and served at 7.5°C using champagne flutes.

Champagne bottle sizes

Champagne comes in half bottles (375 ml) and full bottles (750 ml). Some are also available in 200 ml bottles, as well as a range of larger bottles each with their own name:

- Magnum – equivalent to 2 bottles
- Jeroboam – equivalent to 4 bottles
- Rehoboam – equivalent to 6 bottles
- Methuselah – equivalent to 8 bottles
- Salmanazar – equivalent to 12 bottles
- Balthazar – equivalent to 16 bottles
- Nebuchadnezzar – equivalent to 20 bottles.



Champagne and sparkling wine websites

- http://www.champagne.com/en_indx.html
- <http://www.moet.com/>
- <http://www.veuve-clicquot.com/>

- <http://www.wineaustralia.com/Australia/Default.aspx?tabid=807>
- <http://www.winediva.com.au/>.

Fortified wines

Fortified wines are base wines which are strengthened or 'fortified' by the addition of grape spirit or brandy.

The addition of the grape spirit stops fermentation, increases alcoholic strength, adds sweetness, imparts keeping qualities, and in the case of port provides the brandy character.

Most fortified wines must by law be between 17 – 22% alc/vol.

The standard industry size serve for a fortified wine is 60 ml.

Fortified wines include:

Sherries

Served as an aperitif, Sherries are available in:

- Dry – which is often kept under refrigeration and served chilled
- Medium
- Sweet
- Cream.



You can tell the difference between a dry sherry and a sweet sherry that are on a drinks tray because the sweet sherry is darker in colour.

Vermouth

Vermouth is a white wine that has been infused with various herbs, spices, flowers, fruits etc. This normally depends on the manufacturer.

It is available in red (rosso) often referred to as Italian, or white (bianco) which is also referred to as French. It is used (or mixed) as a pre- dinner drink.

Visit http://cocktails.about.com/od/liqueurscordials/g/dry_vermouth.htm for more information.



Ports

White port is produced in the same way as red, with the same difference in production as the difference in production of red and white table wines. The time on skins is either far less, or non-existent.

The final product in white port is usually much sweeter than the red port, even where the labels read 'dry' or even 'extra dry'.

Ruby port

Ruby port is amongst the simplest and most inexpensive due to the fact that it is aged in bulk vats, not smaller barrels, and bottled young (after 2 – 3 years) after blending. It retains a deep ruby colour and a 'fiery' taste. Mulberry flavours are often traditionally associated with ruby wine.

Tawny port

Tawny port gets its name from the tawny colour that port gets from its wood ageing or the use in tawny of a lighter base wine, or the blending of a red port with a white one.

Vintage port

Vintage port is a port that is simple to make being made of blended wines from the one vintage, yet is the most expensive in part due to the fact that only the very best grapes are used. Not every year will be a year when a 'vintage' can be declared.

Despite being a fortified wine, vintage port has a limited shelf life. After opening it should be consumed within 2 – 3 days.

Liqueur port

Liqueur port is produced when after some time tawny ports become so concentrated or liqueured through evaporation through casks that their very nature has changed. The evaporation reduces the liquid volume but concentrates the sugar, colour and flavour present and results in a port of liqueur-like character.

Alternatively, and more cheaply, a sweet white wine can be added to the tawny before bottling producing a vanilla/nutty flavour.

Muscat

The name can refer to either grapes, or to the wine they make.

Muscat is a red dessert wine with a rich raisin taste and smoky characteristic.

The Liqueur Muscat is made in the same way as the natural liqueur port.

Tokay

This is a simplified version of the Hungarian original wine 'Tokaj'.

Tokay is similar to muscat in terms of production method, and produced from Muscadelle. It is matured in oak barrels, up to 2,000 litres in size in the Solera system, and blended before bottling.



Wine growing countries

Many countries around the world produce wine, whether as identified above, or in their own format and styles. So what are the major wine producing countries?

Top 10 wine producing countries (2011)		
Rank	Country	Wine production (in Hecto Litres)
1	France	46,500,000
2	Italy	44,010,000
3	Spain	42,800,000
4	United States	20,800,000
5	Argentina	13,230,000
6	China	11,600,000
7	Australia	10,200,000
8	South Africa	8,850,000
9	Germany	8,190,000
10	Portugal	7,340,000

Source: <http://www.seriousrankings.com/top-10-wine-producing-countries/>
Date: 10/26/2011

Spirits

Spirits are a popular drink in many bars.

There are five basic spirits:

- Whisky
- Rum
- Gin
- Vodka
- Brandy.



Whisky

Whisky is made from grain (barley, rye, maize, cereal) and distilled in either a Continuous or Pot still.

Whisky is produced in many styles with the four main ones being:

- Scotch
- Irish
- Bourbon
- Rye.

Scotch Whisky

There are two distinct types – grain and malt.

Blended together they make a third version being the common whiskies such as Haig, Johnnie Walker and J & B are blends.

The standard blend is 60% grain to 40% malt.

Blending can involve up to thirty whiskies of different ages and from various distilleries making a standard blend.

Traditionally only the malt whisky from the Highlands was true whisky. Malts are well liked by whisky connoisseurs who have personal preferences. A malt whisky is lighter in colour and smoother than other whisky.



Grain Whisky

Scotland's grain whisky is made from maize with malted and sometimes un-malted barley.

The product is light with no peat flavour.

There is little demand for it to drink straight and it is primarily used for blending.

De Luxe Scotch Whisky

The whisky is older and mellower with a blend age of seven to twelve years.

Malt Whisky

It is made from malted barley.

Malting consists of spreading wetted barley on a warm floor, so the seeds begin to germinate. This converts starch into sugar, also known as maltose.

To halt the process it is next dried at a hotter temperature using peat.

The peat fumes give the unique flavour.

Common brands

Popular brands of scotch include:

- Johnnie Walker – red label, blue label, black label, green label and gold label
- Ballantines
- The Famous Grouse
- Teacher's
- Grants
- Dewar's
- Black and White
- Vat 69
- Chivas Regal
- Haig's Dimple



- Glenmorange
- Glenlivet
- Glenfiddich Single Malt 12 years old.

Irish Whiskey

Always spelt with an 'e' and is made basically the same as whisky with some variations.

The cereals may not be wholly barley, drying is by coal fire not peat, and stills differ in design.

Examples include:

- Jameson
- Paddy's
- Tullamore Dew.

Bourbon and Rye Whiskies

Bourbon is made in Bourbon County in the state of Kentucky in the USA.

Rye is made in the USA and Canada.

Both are produced from grain (mainly maize) distilled in a Continuous still, and aged in charred oak barrels.

Bourbon is aged in cold warehouses, Rye in heated rooms. Both are lighter than scotch.

Popular brands include:

- Wild Turkey Kentucky Straight Bourbon Whiskey
- Jim Beam Kentucky Straight Bourbon Whiskey
- Cougar Bourbon.

Note that whilst Jack Daniels is similar in style to a Kentucky Bourbon, it originates in the adjacent state of Tennessee.



Rum

Rum is distilled from molasses which is a by-product of cane sugar.

Whilst rum can be produced in many hot areas most rums sold come from the Caribbean.

Rum is distilled by Pot or Continuous still and often blended.

It may be aged in oak and caramel can be added for colour.

Jamaican rum

Known for highly-flavoured rums, but today light rums are distilled too with a trend for these.

Popular brands

Popular brands of rum include:

- Captain Morgan – spiced gold, dark, deluxe, white and gold
- Bundaberg – underproof and overproof, Royal Liqueur, Distillers No 3
- Bacardi – white, gold and black.



Gin

Gin is produced by rectifying a pure spirit with berries and botanical herbs. Juniper berries and coriander seeds are the main flavouring agents, along with calamus root, cardamom seeds, angelica, orange and lemon peels, almond and orris root.

London Gin

May be clear (like Gilbey's London Dry and Gordon's), or straw coloured (like Booth's).

Dutch gins are also popular. They are heavier in body and more aromatic. They are also referred to as 'Holland's' or 'Genever'.



Vodka

Is distilled from a base of grain or molasses and is highly rectified meaning impurities have been removed. No flavourings are added, indeed charcoal is used to filter it and produce a clean and smooth spirit.

Flavoured vodkas

Polish vodka is excellent, some varieties being flavoured with fruit or herbs.

Growing in popularity, flavoured vodkas can feature cherries, rowan berries, pears, cranberries, green apple, strawberries, raspberries, vanilla, oranges or lemons.

Popular brands

Popular brands include:

- Grey Goose
- Stolichnaya
- Finlandia
- Wyborowa
- Smirnoff
- Skyy.



Brandy

Is distilled from wine, and is produced in nearly every wine growing region. It may be consumed neat but is popular with a mixer, or in cocktails.

Popular brands include:

- St Remy
- Hardy's Black Bottle.

Cognac

The most famous brandy is Cognac made in the Cognac region of France.

When drinking cognac, a nip is poured into a balloon glass of moderate size. The hand is cupped around the balloon and the cognac gently swirled, warming it and releasing its bouquet.

Popular brands are:

- Courvoisier
- Remy
- Napoleon.



Tequila

Is a Mexican spirit ranging from clear to pale gold in colour.

True Tequila is made in the areas surrounding the city of Tequila.

Some brands feature the classic worm in the bottle.

Tequila is made from Maguey cactus plants.

Popular brands include:

- José Cuervo
- El Toro
- Coyote.



Alcoholic strengths

Proof

'Proof' is a way of indicating the alcoholic strength of drinks.

In America their proof scale runs from 0° proof (for water) up to 200° proof for pure alcohol.

In the American system 'proof' is double the alcohol by volume figure.

For example, a product that is '80 proof' is 40% alc/vol.

Alcohol by volume

‘Alcohol by volume’ as a percentage (%alc/vol) is the more common way to measure alcohol content and the one that is used in most parts of the world.

Common mixers with spirits

Common mixers (soft drink) used with spirits are as follows:

- Gin – tonic water, lemon squash, bitter lemon, lemonade, orange juice: ‘Pink Gin’ is gin with the addition of a few drops of Angostura bitters that have been swirled around the glass
- Brandy – dry ginger, cola, lemonade
- Whisky – dry ginger, cola
- Rum – cola
- Vodka – lemon squash, orange juice, tomato juice.



Other spirits

Applejack

Brandy distilled from the fermented mash of cider apples in the New England region of the USA.

The best is Pot distilled with a minimum maturation of 2 years in oak casks.

It may be bottled straight or combined with neutral spirits and sold as blended applejack.

Aquavit

Is the drink of Scandinavia and the word comes from ‘aqua vitae’, Latin for ‘water of life’.

Grain or potato is distilled to produce a neutral spirit which is then redistilled with caraway and other flavourings such as citrus peel, cardamom or anise.

Aquavit is served ice cold and as it is highly alcoholic it is usually served with food.

Arrack

Produced in Eastern countries and is a spirit distilled from various bases such as grapes or rice.

Toddy is a spirit distilled from the fermented sap of palm trees; Raki is a Turkish drink which is anise flavoured.

Batavia arrack is a rum produced in Java and further aged in Holland and is the base for Swedish Punsch.

Barack Palinka

Hungarian apricot brandy.

Calvados

A brandy made from a mash of cider apples produced in the defined areas of the provinces of Brittany, Normandy and Maine.

The fermented mash is double Pot distilled and then matured in oak casks for up to 25 years, picking up colour and flavour from the wood.



Eau de Vie

These are true fruit brandies made by distilling the fermented mash of fruit.

They usually have a higher alcoholic content than most liqueurs and are dry to the taste and the majority are colourless because they are aged in glass.

Grappa

The solid matter left in the presses after the juice has been extracted from the grapes, consisting of the skins, stalks and pips is known as the 'Marc'.

The distillation of the fermented Marc produces the grappa. In Italy some grappa is oak matured and is flavoured with grass-like herbs. It is known as Marc Brandy in France and as Trester in Germany.

Kirsch

Originally double Pot distilled cherry brandy from the Alsace region in France.

Kirschwasser

German or Swiss cherry brandy.

Ouzo

Aniseed flavoured spirit of Greece and Cyprus.

Quality ouzo is made by double distillation of the basic spirit with the addition of aniseed and other herbs before redistillation.

The better quality the ouzo the more milky it becomes with the addition of water.



Pernod

Origin is in Southern France. It was named after Monsieur Pernod who bought the recipe in 1897.

The original recipe contained absinthe, however this was banned on 14th August 1914 for making men mad and vicious.

Pernod has a similar taste to ouzo and goes milky with the addition of water.

Pisco

South American spirit distilled from the residue of muscat grapes and matured in clay jars.

It is named after the town of Pisco in Peru and is the base of Pisco sour popular in Chile and Peru.

Poire Williams

Eau-de-vie de poire is distilled from the pear known as Williams or Bartlett.

It is sometimes marketed in a pear-shaped bottle with a ripe pear inside.

Slivovitz

A plum brandy from Yugoslavia and other Balkan countries.

Liqueurs

Liqueurs are spirits that have been flavoured with fruits, herbs, roots and plants, sweetened and sometimes artificially coloured.

Liqueurs are proprietary or generic.

Proprietary brands are those produced by a single company such as Grand Marnier, Cointreau, Tia Maria, and Galliano.

Generics are types of liqueurs that can be made by any company. As an example, Bols produce a range of generic liqueurs that includes Advocaat, Banana, Blue Curacao, Crème de cacao, Crème de menthe, Triple Sec.



Many liqueurs trace their ancestry back to the monasteries where monks collected herbs and turned them into medicines: in fact, many do have digestive properties.

Liqueurs are made by soaking flavouring materials in a spirit. The number of flavourings may be huge with Chartreuse having a hundred and thirty herbs, and Benedictine at least thirty.

Standard serve size for a liqueur is 30 ml.

Types of liqueurs

Advocaat

A low strength liqueur, thick yellow and creamy made from raw eggs and brandy spirit.

Anisette

A sweetened version of Anis, a name that comes from the star anise plant.

Apricot

Made by macerating apricots with brandy.

Bailey's Irish Cream

Cream blended with whiskey, neutral spirits, coffee and chocolate.

Benedictine DOM

DOM stands for Deo Optimo Maximo – To God most good, most great.

It is a famous and popular golden liqueur with a complex, herb flavour.

Chartreuse - Green and Yellow

Brandy distilled with numerous herbs: yellow is sweeter – but weaker.

Cherry Brandy

Ripe cherries macerated in brandy.

Cointreau

Colourless liqueur of the Curacao family made by the Cointreau company; it is clear in colour, orange-flavoured with a dry finish.

Creme de Bananes

Sweet, banana-flavoured liqueur which can be consumed on its own, or poured over ice cream.

Creme de Cacao

Sweet liqueur made from cocoa and vanilla beans.

Creme de Cassis

Sweet liqueur made from blackcurrants.

Creme de Menthe

Sweet, mint-flavoured liqueur, available in either a clear or green colour.

Drambuie

Made from Scotch whisky, herbs and honey; it is sweet and golden.

Grand Marnier

Distilled oranges steeped in cognac.

Irish Mist Liqueur

Made from heather, honey and whiskey.

Kahlua

Mexican coffee-flavoured liqueur.



Curacao

Distilled from peel of bitter oranges.

Blue Curacao uses sweet Valencia orange peel with colouring.

For dry orange, bitters and sugar are used.

Jagermeister

A bitter tasting liqueur made from herbs, roots and spices.

Recommended to be served from the freezer.

Kummel

Distilled grain spirit flavoured with caraway seeds.

Maraschino

Sweet liqueur made from cherries.

Midori

Honey dew melon liqueur.

Parfait d'Amour

Sweet, highly scented, violet-coloured liqueur.

Peach Brandy

Peaches steeped in brandy.

Royal Mint Chocolate

Like a liquid after dinner mint.

Sambuca

Aniseed-flavoured colourless liqueur.

Sloe Gin

Sloe berries steeped in gin, giving a rich, deep-red liqueur.

Strega

Means 'witch' in Italian: features many herbs and barks of trees.

Tia Maria

Distilled from sugar cane and flavoured with Blue Mountain coffee.



Non-alcoholic drinks

Non-alcoholic drinks should be available in all liquor outlets to comply with the general principles of Responsible Service of Alcohol.

Non-alcoholic drinks may be hot or cold.

Examples include:

- Varieties of tea – black, semi-black, blended, green, scented
- Coffee – including all espresso-based coffees and the flavours that may be added
- Milk shakes
- Flavoured milks
- Smoothies
- Hot/iced chocolate
- Juices – bought-in and freshly squeezed juices
- Cordials and syrups
- Waters – still, sparkling, flavoured
- Soft drinks – also known as aerated waters. Either bulk ‘post mix’ products or products from bottles or cans
- Non-alcoholic cocktails – known as ‘mocktails’
- Health drinks – including energy drinks
- Frappés
- Children’s specialty drinks
- Energy drinks.



Packaged snack foods

Most retail liquor outlets carry a small range of packaged snack foods that centre on a range of convenient foods that compliment the beverages being sold. These may include:

- Chips/crisps
- Nuts
- Dips and salsas
- Beef jerky
- Confectionery – sweet items, chocolates, cakes, muffins
- Breads and cheeses
- Olives.



Ancillary products

Individual liquor stores and outlets can stock a vast array of products to supplement the liquor products they offer for sale.

These can include, but not limited to:

- Ice
- Cigarettes and tobacco products
- Bottle openers
- Cork stoppers
- Picnic sets
- Sunscreen
- Carry bags
- Drink accessories – such as glassware, cocktail shakers and cocktail equipment (bar spoons, strainers, drink trays, etc.), decorative items for drinks and cocktails (drink umbrellas, straws, swizzle sticks)
- Gift packages and gift vouchers
- Drink and liquor-related books and magazines – monthly industry magazines, recipe books and general interest books on certain beverages and beverage types.



Keys to providing relevant advice

When advising customers on their selection of products the following can be useful:

- Identify needs, wants and preferences – in terms of brands, tastes, type of beverage etc.
- Identify if the beverage is required for a special occasion
- Identify if the beverage is to accompany food – and find out what that food is
- Determine how much the customer wants to spend
- Focus on the customer – give them your full attention.

1.2 Process sales promptly in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

When the customer has made their selection it is vital their choice is processed promptly.

It is vital you maintain a customer focus while you process the sales you make. Never leave the customer thinking you were highly focussed on them while they were making their selection but lost interest in them when they had actually made a decision to buy.

Maintain these high levels of customer service, focus, and attention.

It may be appropriate to comment positively on their choice and remark along the lines of 'I think you'll enjoy that particular wine', 'That should go well with the roast beef', 'You've made a good choice there' or similar.

While processing sales promptly it is important to be alert to determine whether or not the individual customer wants to have a brief chat, or whether they want to be off as quickly as possible.

Customer sales and service

General sales and service should be applied in accordance with house policies. Standard customer service requirements include:

- Smile – make eye contact with each customer
- Use the customer's name if known
- Follow house procedures for cash handling, sales processing, and giving change. Never sacrifice accuracy in processing a sale for speed. Make sure customers are only charged the correct price and ensure they receive the correct change
- Be courteous – 'Please' and 'Thank you' are mandatory: never give the customer the impression you are taking their custom for granted
- Serve customers in the order they arrived at the service counter – if you are not sure who is next, ask
- Make an offer of assistance (such as carrying cartons to the customer's car) where appropriate
- Wish the customer 'Goodbye'.



Guard against engaging customers in drive-in liquor outlets in unnecessary conversation as it can cause traffic to bank-up, and annoy others who are in a hurry.

Responsible service of alcohol

When making any liquor sale, always keep Responsible Service of Alcohol guidelines in mind.

Never serve anyone who is intoxicated, never serve a minor and always be alert to secondary sale situations (where a minor is getting an adult to buy on their behalf).



Opportunities for optimising sales

Your employer will always expect you to optimise every sales situation but it is important you do so without giving the impression you are pressuring customers into buying.

This means sales promotion techniques including up-selling, suggestive selling, using the ABC of Selling.

The ABC of Selling

When selling in the liquor outlet, sales can be increased if the concepts underpinning the 'ABC of Selling' are remembered and put into practice at appropriate moments only.

The ABC of Selling says that sales fall into three different categories – Automatic, Bettered and Created – ABC.

Automatic Sales

The Automatic sale is where a customer comes into the liquor outlet and asks for an item:

“Can I get a cask of red, please? We’re having the boss over for dinner tonight, so I better get some wine to impress her.”

Bettered sale

You would recognise this as an ABC opportunity, and make a suggestion to achieve a Bettered sale: “Sounds like an important meal – may I suggest you consider some premium bottled wine instead of the cask? We have some excellent wine specials this week, and they’re all very well known and well respected names. What are you having to eat?”

Having Bettered the sale (which means increasing the original dollar value of the sale), you next move to the Created sale.

Created sale

“We also have some fine ports available – that might be an excellent way to finish off a business dinner. Do you prefer tawny or vintage, or would a liqueur be better? The Hanwood is on special this week”.



1.3 Complete order forms, invoices and/or receipts accurately in accordance with enterprise and legal requirements

Introduction

Staff in liquor outlets will have to deal with various pieces of paperwork as part of their everyday practice.

Speed and accuracy in handling this aspect of the job is essential.

Any delays can cause customer frustration and anger leading to a downturn in repeat business and adverse word-of-mouth advertising.

Errors with figures are likely to be misinterpreted as an attempt to over-charge the customer, or may result in establishment profits being reduced.

Whenever you are required to calculate figures the golden rule is to use a calculator and double-check your figures.

Examples of dealing with forms can include:

- Completing an in-store order form as the customer dictates their order to you either in person or over the phone
- Completing an establishment invoice that will accompany the supply of goods to a customer
- Supplying a receipt for goods bought and supplied.



Dealing with documents

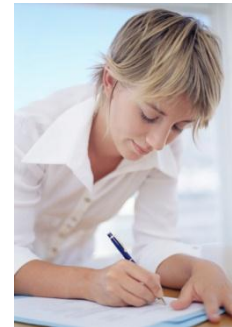
Order forms

Order forms are used to formalise and standardise orders placed by customers.

Only large orders, or orders submitted from some remote location are usually committed to order forms.

It is traditional for the following pieces of information to be recorded on these forms:

- Customer details – name and address, contact details: purchaser's details will not always be the same as that of the recipient
- Delivery requirements – address, date, and time
- Payment details – identification of how payment will be made, and relevant details
- Product description – enabling accurate selection and charging of the desired items
- Quantities involved
- Any special requests – whether wrapping is required, if stock needs to be chilled, whether or not the purchase is as a surprise order, if the delivery is urgent, an indication of what alternatives are acceptable just in case the first choice is unavailable
- Name of the person recording the order – for future reference if necessary
- Declaration that purchaser is over 18 years of age.



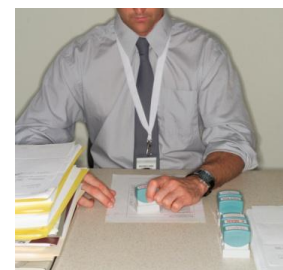
Invoices

Invoices provide the customer with a written account for the goods they have bought, and represent the basis on which the establishment bases its record keeping of debtors.

An invoice is a 'bill' for the goods sold to a customer.

A 'Tax Invoice' (as required under current legislation) must contain the following details:

- Information about the supplier – name, address, contact numbers
- Information about the customer
- A reference number
- Date
- Goods supplied – product description and quantities
- Prices – unit price together with extended prices and a total
- Terms of trade – an indication of when the account should be paid and how
- Additional charges – delivery fees, wrapping, courier, insurance
- The words 'Tax Invoice'
- An indication as to whether or not any service tax has been included.



Invoices may be mailed out to customers after the goods have been delivered, or may accompany the goods when they are delivered.

A duplicate copy is often generated which acts as proof of receipt of the goods when signed for by the customer.

Receipts

In most cases the audit role from the cash register serves as a sufficient receipt, especially where the print out individually itemises and prices products.

In other cases the customer may require a written receipt for some purpose. Perhaps they have to provide proof of purchase in order to be reimbursed from petty cash, etc.

This written receipt details the goods bought and identifies they have been paid for. Some receipts describe the payment method.

Many establishments will keep a standard form 'Receipt Book' somewhere behind the counter, which staff fill in as required, sometimes adding the establishment's ink stamp as verification.



1.4 Operate point of sale equipment in accordance with manufacturer's instructions

Introduction

The range of Point of Sale (POS) equipment that may be found depends very much on the individual establishment.

Some of the equipment is manually operated, some of it is electronically operated.

The two most important points about the operation of POS equipment are:

- To make sure you receive appropriate training before attempting to use it
- Follow manufacturer's instructions regarding its use.

POS equipment

Commonly found items of equipment include:

- Fixed or hand held bar-code reader/scanner
- Cash register – also known as a POS terminal
- EFTPOS terminals
- Credit card processing equipment
- Cash drawer.



House rules and requirements

Whilst the following sections will explore the different functions associated with using these pieces of equipment, when operating point of sale equipment, within every establishment there are likely to be 'House Rules' that govern the use of these pieces of equipment.

Examples of these requirements may address:

- Items must be registered to a specific department – there may be several 'departments/ stock' classifications on the register, and management will expect you to accurately register into the appropriate departments
- Only management may have access to the register security keys. In some establishments, it is common practice for the 'X' and 'Z' reading keys to be taken out of the register and held only by appropriate management
- The cash register drawer must be kept locked when no-one is in attendance – failing to lock the drawer when the register is unattended presents a tempting opportunity to a thief
- Each staff member may have their personal operator number, code or 'swipe bands' – some registers have the facility to divide sales by register operator. This can identify how much each staff member is selling, and can track individual register errors. Analysis of this facility may show extra staff training is needed (either in selling, or cash register operation) for a specific staff member
- No 'No Sales' are allowed to be rung – some outlets will forbid the ringing of 'No Sales' as a security measure. Some managers believe the ringing of No Sales may indicate staff are opening the register when there are no customers around, so they can steal cash from the register drawer. If your outlet has adopted this policy, it can make life difficult for you when a customer asks for change for the parking meter or the telephone but it is critical you abide by this house rule
- No change is to be given out for any purposes – customers find this 'rule' a petty thing but operators often correctly display a sign saying "We have an arrangement with the banks. They don't sell liquor and we don't give change". It can take up a lot of time to be regularly giving change to the public, not to mention it may mean running out of change for genuine customers, and having to carry a higher level of coins and notes just for this non-business purpose
- The liquor outlet floor limit for credit cards may be different to other departments in the establishment – you will need to check with management to identify what level applies.



Management may be required to authorise various actions. Approval may need to be obtained to either access or use certain items, or to perform certain transactions such as refunds, cancellations, etc.

1.5 Ensure all necessary material and/or consumables are available at the point of sale area

Introduction

For any liquor outlet to operate effectively, an adequate supply of dockets, vouchers, and other POS documentation must be maintained.

This section will explore some of the common materials needed to operate and supplement the use of POS equipment and systems.

What is needed?

Maintaining an adequate stock of relevant paper-based documents and materials is as important as maintaining an adequate supply of stock or change.

The first requirement is to identify all the documents your operation uses. Examples include:

- Rolls for EFTPOS machines
- Audit rolls and receipt tapes for POS terminals
- Receipt books – for providing hand-written receipts
- Delivery dockets – for processing liquor deliveries
- Internal requisition and other internal order forms – for ordering stock from your own internal store rooms
- Order forms – forms for taking orders from customers for bulk orders, and order forms that enable us to place orders with our suppliers
- Credit slips – forms we give to customers who return a product for some reason or other, and we determine this return entitles them to a credit. Some establishments will prefer to exercise this option rather than give the customer a cash refund
- Refund documentation – used where the customer is entitled to a refund
- Credit card charge vouchers – for manual processing. Even where an on-line EFTPOS facility exists there can always be times when the system is down or there is a power failure and you need to process a credit card sale using the manual (handwritten and imprinted) system
- 'Specials' advertisements and flyers – these are promotional materials used by the store to notify customers about sales and specials
- Gift vouchers – not all outlets offer this service but where they are used a full selection of values should be available. Where applicable – some outlets use a standard gift voucher and add in the value of the voucher to each individual card/voucher
- Forms to request change, whether coins and notes, from management or the bank



- It should become a standard part of your normal working day to monitor these paper-based supplies and take steps to order them where necessary
- Remember that customers get irate when they get to the check out stage and are held up just because you haven't got a certain form – it delays their buying trip, frustrates them, and creates lots of negative attitude towards the liquor outlet.

Slow service and getting a reputation for not stocking popular lines (sometimes referred to as 'stock outages') are amongst the top reasons why customers are likely to shop elsewhere.

Prepare register station

As mentioned a cash register is a machine that is commonly used to accurately record transactions – both charges and methods of payments, issue accounts and receipts and to store cash and non-cash payments.

Besides the tasks mentioned on the previous page that need to be set up, additional register specific tasks to be performed include ensuring there is an adequate supply of:

- Cash register paper
- Price lists
- Pens
- Receipt paper
- Account folders
- Ink cartridge
- Plastic coin bags
- Sweets or other gifts normally presented with accounts to customers
- Rubbish bins
- Ribbons and roles
- Spare paper
- Calculator
- Currency exchange sheet, if foreign currency is permitted to be used for settlement of transactions.



Prepare associated items

It is important to have a clear understanding of information that may effect cashiering duties for the day including:

- Function sheets including event items, pricing, contact names and authorisation information
- Methods of payment for VIP or special groups or customers
- Prices for new menu items, specials of the day or promotions.

How do you obtain extra paper-based stock?

This will depend on the structure and size of the business.

Typically you will:

- Ask management
- Obtain it yourself from the store room or office where these items are kept.

1.6 Maintain cash drawer and float in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

One of the key requirements when setting up POS and registers for a liquor outlet is to ensure there is sufficient money to provide change to customers and to ensure the smooth handling of cash transactions.

Receive and accurately check cash float

A cash float, also known as 'the float' is the amount of money that an establishment has deemed appropriate to commence the day's trading for a cash register/point-of-sale (POS) terminal.

Found in the cash drawer of the cash register/POS terminal, a cash float is necessary for giving out change when completing a financial transaction, because rarely will a customer provide the exact amount of money to settle an account.



Overnight, most cash floats/cash drawers will be stored in a safe and at the beginning of each shift or day's trading, the cash float/cash drawer will be removed by management, security, or someone from the Accounts department and either placed into the cash registers or distributed to the appropriate staff members in outlets.

Counting a cash float

When this happens, individual staff members may need to sign for their float to prove they have taken possession of it.

When signing for a float, the staff member needs to be sure the amount said to be in the float is accurate and consistent with the actual amount found in the cash drawer.



It is common practice therefore to count the float before signing for it or immediately after signing for it to ensure its contents. It is too late at the end of the shift to claim the float was short at the start of the day.

Some properties have two sheets for this process. They require the person handing over the float to count and sign in relation to the float and then the person receiving the float also has to count and sign for it.

Where a discrepancy in the amount in the float is detected, ask the person who delivered the float to double-check it.

Once you have collected your float, it is important to place your float in a secure location. This is normally in a cash drawer in a cash register.

1.7 Record transactions in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

Whilst the types of transactions within a liquor outlet will differ between venues and days of operations, there is one thing that is certain: transactions will take place each and every day.

Types of transactions

There are a number of transactions that may take place when selling beverages, food and other items in a liquor outlet. These include, but are not limited to:

- Cash
- Cheque
- Credit cards
- EFTPOS
- Refunds
- Returned goods
- Account payment.

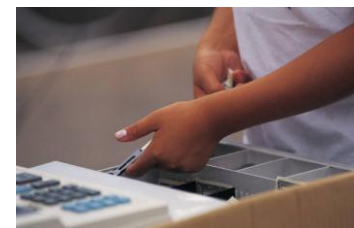


Cash register operation

The operation of the register will differ depending on the type and model.

The basic method of accepting cash, registering it, and giving change however should stay the same:

- Accept money and thank customer
- Place money on cash register ledge
- Ring through account total on register
- Place money in appropriate compartments in register
- Ring amount tendered on register – press total to determine the amount of change to be given, or mentally calculate it
- Count out change – using the minimum number of notes and coins unless the customer requests differently
- Return change to customer – counting it out to the customer and again thanking them
- Some premises require staff to give the change to the customer before physically placing the money tendered in the register so as to guard against dispute regarding how much money was handed over.



Bar-code scanner

When using a bar-code scanner to process a sale:

- Pass the item in front of the scanner – or point a hand-held scanner at the bar code until the POS terminal registers the product
- Use your knowledge of prices (including specials, deals, etc.) to verify the system is charging the correct price
- Repeat process for all items being purchased
- Total the sale and process according to house policy.

EFTPOS

The process to use the EFTPOS system to process credit card payments is:

- The customer's card is swiped at the relevant terminal
- The account balance is then entered into the keypad. Refer to operator's instructional manual for further details as to how to process credit card transactions using this type of system
- The system then processes the credit card payment
- Once payment has been 'approved', the customer either signs for the transaction or enters their PIN (Personal Identification Number)
- When signatures or PIN have been verified, the customer is issued with their receipt and a copy of the slip is placed into the cash drawer.



Many establishments have EFTPOS (Electronic Funds Transfer at Point Of Sale) terminals to accept cash payments. This is the same system that is used to electronically process credit card payments.

The EFTPOS system offers a banking service of deducting money from a customer's savings or cheque account and depositing it into the establishment's account.

When using this system to pay their account, the customer must present the cashier with the relevant bank card and then enter a 4- to 6-digit PIN (Personal Identification Number) into the system for verification purposes.

Once the payment has been approved, the customer will be issued with a receipt.

Cash out services

With this system, the customer may have the option of having 'Cash Out'. This means the customer can withdraw additional funds from their account over and above the amount required to settle the restaurant account.

Note that not all establishments offer 'Cash Out' services - refer and adhere to house policy on this. Before using an EFTPOS terminal, make sure you refer to and read the instruction manual. Familiarise yourself with its operation, and get someone to show you how to use it.

Personal cheques

Every establishment will have their own policy about accepting personal cheques.

Generally, most venues will not accept personal or business cheques as payment unless prior arrangement has been made. This allows management to check to see if the person or business has sufficient funds, and enables them to decide if they will 'take the risk'.



Some establishments will accept payment by cheque from regular customers. Management will usually know where these people live, where they work, or something else about them – what car they drive, clubs they belong to, and so on.

When dealing with cheques you must definitely make sure you follow house policies. If you don't know what the policies are, you must find out immediately.

Some places will accept payment by cheque if the person has a recognised means of identification; some will only accept payment for the amount of the account, with no additional cash out facility; some places will cash a cheque for a set, small level (say, \$50) just to get customers 'out of trouble', even though there is no account to be paid.

Accounts

Some establishments may offer accounts to selected customers or companies. In some cases, these accounts will be put in place where the person/business seeks this service, usually by writing a letter requesting credit facilities.



Once account facilities have been established, customers have the option of charging items to their account, and paying on a weekly or monthly basis, or otherwise as arranged.

Some accounts have certain limits or conditions set on them. For instance, a company may arrange credit facilities for specific levels of management.

It is standard procedure to have the customer sign the individual accounts to avoid any confusion or disagreement when a query is made, or when time for payment arrives.

When dealing with accounts, staff should always follow and adhere to the individual establishment's house policy.

Vouchers

Some hospitality establishments issue vouchers for individual food and beverage items, services, or for a specific dollar amount.



Vouchers are also popular ways of conducting promotions with the vouchers being only redeemable in those departments.

People then present these vouchers at the relevant in-house department and receive products or services up to the voucher amount.

When cashing vouchers, it's important you make sure that the voucher is still valid and that the voucher is being used in accordance with any conditions.

Conditions may include specific times of the day, the need for something else to accompany it – ‘buy one, get one free’, only redeemable for certain target market segments, available only on weekends, available only certain days/nights of the week.

Some vouchers are issued for a specific dollar amount (say, \$50.00) and may also have certain conditions.

For example: if someone presented you with a \$50.00 voucher for a bottle of wine and the account came to \$35.00, the customer may or may not be able to receive \$15.00 cash as change.

Some establishments may issue another voucher for \$15.00 to cover the change so that the guest could, for example, use that money in the gaming room or elsewhere in the venue.

Foreign currency

Some properties, relatively few, are prepared to accept payment via foreign currency.

Agreement must occur regarding the conversion rate before this method of payment is accepted.

In these cases, any change will be provided in local currency.



Traveller's cheques

Properties accepting traveller's cheques usually advertise the fact that they do so.

You are not legally obliged to accept payment via traveller's cheque.

It is critical that the second customer signature is placed on the cheque while you watch. Compare this with the first signature that already exists on the cheque: any traveller's cheque that is presented to you with two signatures already on it must be refused.

Identify and process customer delivery requirements

Not all liquor outlets provide a delivery service – where liquor service is provided most liquor outlets have a set of non-negotiable protocols that apply.

Pre-requisite requirements

Most liquor outlets will only deliver liquor under certain conditions.

These commonly include:

- Goods must be paid for prior to delivery – most liquor outlets do not do ‘Cash on Delivery’
- A minimum purchase quantity – this may be a dollar value (minimum \$50 or \$100) or by quantity (for example, minimum 1 dozen bottles)
- Items will not be left at addresses where there is no one to accept delivery – if there is no one there, a card advising a delivery was attempted may be left and the goods may be returned to the outlet for the customer to pick-up. This is to avoid theft and to help avoid delivery to addresses where there are under-age persons



- No liquor will be delivered to minors – if the delivery person is uncertain about a person's age, proof of age will be required. If satisfactory proof of age cannot be supplied, the delivery will be refused
- Deliveries may only be made within a prescribed geographic area – the outlet may refuse sales outside this area or may charge a fee for delivery. Local liquor deliveries are usually provided free-of-charge.

Details needed to provide a delivery service

An order for delivery may be placed in person by a customer, be taken over the phone, be received by fax or mail or arrive via the internet. As mentioned, deliveries usually have to be paid for before delivery will be made.

The following information needs to be obtained before a home delivery can be effectively made:

- Name of the customer and their contact details – a phone number is a good contact
- The address to where the delivery is to go – it may be necessary to get verbal directions in some instances, as a simple street address may not suffice
- Special instructions – such as delivery time, delivery date, wrapping, use of side door
- Precise nature of the goods to be delivered – by quantity, type, brand name, vintage, size, quality (for example, five-star, or 'blue label').



Most outlets will have some form of documentation to complete that helps recording phone and personal orders.

The pro forma style of this document will also serve to prompt you to ask questions to make sure you obtain all the relevant details from the customer.

In some instances there may be a duplicate 'Delivery Book', where the duplicate copy stays in the book and the delivery driver takes the original with them, whilst other outlets have a duplicate single leaf 'Delivery Docket'.

Other establishments may use an invoice as the basis for the delivery.

Customer service standards

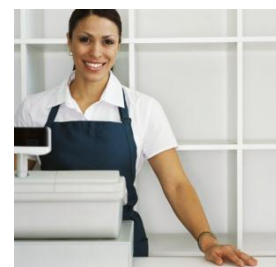
To help ensure that accurate financial transactions occur each and every time, staff must accurately and promptly record the transaction immediately after the service or product has been provided to the customer.

Establishment standards will vary between properties.

Issues that relate to customer service standards include:

Honesty and integrity – not charging for items that were not delivered; not charging person X for something that person Y received:

- Accuracy – checking all entries, extensions, additions and other calculations



- Speed – ensuring that accounts are compiled and presented in a timely manner
- Explanation and description of charges – fully detailing the nature of all charges so that no confusion or suspicion about charges exists
- Customer service – treating customers with the courtesy, attention and personalised service they merit.

Speed and accuracy

Processing any financial transaction will always involve the twin elements of time (speed) and accuracy.

While we want to service customers quickly, there is also a concurrent need to make sure our figures and processes are accurate.

Being quick but creating incorrect accounts or charging the wrong prices is unacceptable from both the customer's point of view and from the establishment's viewpoint.

On balance, if you have to choose between accuracy and speed, always choose accuracy. Take a bit longer on the transaction, but make sure you get it right.



1.8 Follow security procedures in accordance with enterprise requirements

Introduction

Each organisation will have their own security procedures to ensure that all cash and non cash transactions are not only conducted in a secure manner, but the notes and documents themselves are securely handled.

This section will explore some of the common security measures used in retail liquor outlet.

Use cash registers correctly

Whilst the process of using cash registers may seem like a simple process, not needing further explanation, it is important that any money or documents taken be properly secured.

During a service period you will receive large amounts of money and credit card slips through the processing of large amounts of transactions.

Theft of money and personal information from credit card slips is common throughout the world, and this is no less true in food and beverage outlets.

In your role there may be many tasks that you will perform, with processing accounts and handling money only one aspect of your day, however it is vital that security is foremost in your mind.



Secure money and documentation during trade

Following are helpful tips to employ to increase the security of cash and non-cash payments:

- Try not to share cash registers
- Never leave a cash register open when unattended
- Keep cash registers out of the reach of customers
- Lock cash registers when not in use
- Keep the original note on display whilst a transaction is taking place. This reduces any discrepancies that may arise as to what monetary value the customer has given the staff member at the start of the transaction
- Regularly store large notes under the cash till, out of display of customers
- Regularly arrange for cash registers to be cleared.



Remove payments received and transport according to organisation security procedures

Removing monies from cash registers traditionally happens at the end of each day, or session.

Removal of cash can also occur throughout the day, especially during busy trading periods.

During trade

Reasons for money to be taken from registers during very busy times include:

- Stopping it from falling out, or becoming stuck under the till drawer
- Making the register easier for staff to use – a really full till drawer is more difficult to work with
- Reducing the temptation for customers and staff to steal – ‘I’ll just take one \$50 note – they won’t miss it with all these here!’
- Reducing actual loss in the event of a robbery.



Removal of cash from tills during trading is called ‘stripping’ the registers and is only to be done by authorised people. Anyone stripping a register without permission may be deemed to be stealing.

Whenever money is stripped from a register, some form of receipt for it must be placed in the drawer so that the final balance can factor in the absent cash.

Registers may be stripped on the basis of personal judgement that there is ‘too much’ money/notes in the register: some systems incorporate a signal indicating that takings in the register have reached a nominated level and a set amount of money needs to be removed from the register.

End of trade

At the end of trade or near the end of trade, cash drawers may be removed from registers/terminals to a secure location and counted.

This may be inadvisable, however, because even though you may be behind a shutter, an armed robber can still shove a shotgun through the openings – and then what are you going to do?

In still other circumstances, the registers may be read, and counted behind the counter after all the customers have left, blinds have been drawn and the doors have been locked.

Safes

Most premises have safes on-site to hold cash.

These must be of a certain standard as required by insurance companies to guard against safebreakers. No safe is seen as totally secure, but the intention is to make them so difficult to break into that the time needed to break into them will be too long, and function as a disincentive to potential thieves.

Most safes are required to be TDR – Torch and Drill Resistant – or in-ground safes.

Cash collection services

These are armed guards who will attend to remove large amounts of cash from the property at prearranged times.

The process for these collections are:

- You count the cash and complete documentation showing them how much is there or you believe there is
- They give you a cheque in return
- The cash collection company takes your money away in an armoured vehicle – once the guards have signed for it, it is their responsibility.



Any discrepancies are sorted out later between the venue and the cash collection company.

Night safes

Some premises utilise 'hole in the wall night safes' to hold the day's takings.

One or two staff members (usually management or security) drive to the night safe and, using a key, deposit a satchel containing the cash and paperwork into the night safe for safe deposit.



Attention has to be paid to the potential for hold-ups when using night safes.

Sometimes the local police may be prepared to accompany you to the safe where there is a very high level of takings to be banked.

Other measures that can be taken to minimise the likelihood for theft in this regard include:

- Banking at irregular times
- Travelling by different routes
- Using different vehicles
- Using different staff.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 1.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to provide advice or information to customers on different types of products available.
 - 1.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to process sales promptly.
 - 1.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to complete order forms, invoices and/or receipts.
 - 1.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to operate point of sale equipment.
 - 1.5 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to ensure all necessary material and/or consumables are available at the point of sale area.
 - 1.6 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to maintain cash drawer and float.
 - 1.7 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify security procedures that should be followed when processing transactions.
-

Summary

Complete liquor sales

Provide advice or information to customers on different types of products available

- What sort of information do I need to know?
- Ways to develop product knowledge
- Products in a liquor outlet
- Beer
- Wine
- Spirits
- Alcoholic strengths
- Common mixers with spirits
- Liqueurs
- Non-alcoholic drinks
- Packaged snack foods
- Ancillary products
- Keys to providing relevant advice.

Process sales promptly in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Customer sales and service
- Responsible service of alcohol
- Opportunities for optimising sales.

Complete order forms, invoices and/or receipts accurately in accordance with enterprise and legal requirements

- Dealing with documents.

Operate point of sale equipment in accordance with manufacturer's instructions

- POS equipment
- House rules and requirements.

Ensure all necessary material and/or consumables are available at the point of sale area

- What is needed?

Maintain cash drawer and float in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Receive and accurately check cash float
- Counting a cash float.

Record transactions in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Types of transactions
- Cash register operation
- Bar-code scanner
- EFTPOS
- Personal cheques
- Accounts
- Vouchers

- Foreign currency
- Traveller's cheques
- Identify and process customer delivery requirements
- Customer service standards
- Speed and accuracy.

Follow security procedures in accordance with enterprise requirements

- Use cash registers correctly
- Secure money and documentation during trade
- Remove payments received and transport according to organisation security procedures.

Element 2: Pack goods

2.1 Maintain adequate supplies of wrapping materials

Introduction

Despite the trend towards reducing the use of plastic bags in retail sales environments, liquor outlets traditionally continue to offer paper bags to customers for the items they purchase.

Make sure you identify what packing and wrapping requirements apply at your workplace and adhere to these.

The notes in this section are an indicative guide only.

Wrapping materials and bags

Frequent checks should be made of your supplies of wrapping materials.

A quick check before you open and then another check after lunch should ensure you never run out, providing you take the appropriate action to replenish dwindling stocks.

Consider the following needs for wrapping:

- Single-bottle bags
- Double-bottle bags
- Three-bottle bags
- Four-bottle bags
- Six-bottle bags
- Long-neck bags
- Half cartons – boxes that 1 dozen bottles of beer were delivered in, cut in half
- Full cartons – can cartons, wine cartons, long-neck bottle cartons
- Special occasion bags – for Christmas, birthdays, etc.
- Gift wrapping paper
- Sticky tape
- Scissors
- Ribbon and bows
- Gift cards.



Wrapping options

Note not all establishments will carry or use all the above items and so will use differing wrapping and packing options.

For instance, one liquor outlet may always pack four bottles of beer or liquor in two x two bottle bags, not a four-bottle bag.

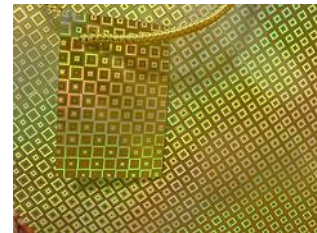
Another shop may never use a three-bottle bag, preferring to wrap three bottles in a single bottle bag and a double-bottle bag.

Six bottles may always be put in a half carton rather than being 'bagged'.

Gift wrapping

Most liquor stores do not offer a gift wrapping service as part of their normal service. They may offer, for sale, a range of draw-string gift bags which the customer can buy and put their purchase into.

Where gift wrapping is available, wrapping materials are usually kept behind or adjacent to the service counter with back-up supplies to be found in a near-by store room.



New supplies of stock

Where you need to re-order new stock of wrapping and packing materials your supplier of wrapping materials may be:

- Wine and spirit wholesalers with whom you deal – many of these distributors also sell quite a few non-liquor but industry-related supplies. Refer to their Order Guides to see what they supply
- The liquor buying group to which you belong – and which will have its name/logo on the bag
- Head office – in the case of hotels, stores and liquor outlets who are members of a chain, purchases of bags may have to be processed through some central point
- Your local paper products supplier.

Common purchase quantities are bundles of 500.



2.2 Pack goods in a suitably sized bag or container that adequately protects the goods, or wrap goods neatly and effectively

Introduction

When wrapping liquor products, care must be paid to ensure it is wrapped appropriately for the individual sale.

This means special attention needs to be paid when:

- Packing stock for home delivery
- Gift wrapping
- Meeting specifically stated customer requirements.

At all times, wrapping needs to ensure the safety and security of the items being wrapped.



Customer service

Every time we 'register and wrap' a liquor purchase we have an opportunity to give the customer a non-verbal message about what we think of them by the way we wrap their purchase.

Do we manage to say "We care about how we serve you, we value you as a customer, and we want your business"?

Or do we send the message "Quick, get going – we've got better things to do than look after you properly"?

The important message is 'wrapping the sale is part of customer service'.



Gift wrapping

Where gift wrapping is offered there are two basic options:

- Keep a non-occasion-specific paper that can be used for all situations – something that is plain in colour or has non-specific graphics on it rather than wedding bells, candles or gender-specific pictures
- Keep a supply of four or five occasion specific papers as well as a general sort – this allows you to wrap a purchase up in a "Happy Birthday" wrap, a "Congratulations" wrap or a "Merry Christmas" wrap as required.



Ensure that our supply of wrapping materials are well looked after and not subjected to unnecessary rough treatment or damage.

Make sure they are stored out of harm's way, where they can't get wet and are stored away from areas likely to cause them to become faded, ripped or tatty.

To bag or to box

For the individual bottle purchase, or the two or three bottle buys the decision is fairly simple.

A bag of appropriate size should be used. The customer could be asked though if they would like their selections individually wrapped but this rare.

Take the correct size bag and have a quick check to make sure it is in sound condition. Make sure it is not ripped, torn or somehow damaged. We don't want the bag breaking and the customer's bottles smashing on the ground.

Open the bag up using your hand. Customers object to you blowing into the bag to help open it up and carefully place the bottles inside.

Make sure you put them in straight and don't place them at an angle; this is particularly common when putting the first bottle into a two-bottle or three-bottle bag.

Then, if using a paper bag, fold the top over or screw it around tightly to seal the bag.

The aim is to provide the customer with a neatly wrapped bottle, not something that looks as if no care, consideration, or trouble has been taken.

Then hand the wrapped goods over to the customer making sure you have a secure hold on them, and ensuring that the customer has a firm grip before releasing yours.



Pre-bagging

Many outlets pre-bag their beer to speed up the sales process.

This means during quiet times staff are engaged in wrapping single bottles and two-bottles (putting them in bags), and stocking them in the refrigerators ready for sale, pre-bagged.

The same care should be taken when pre-bagging as when wrapping the goods in front of the customer.

In some circumstances though, a carton of some kind can be the best option.

A half beer carton is commonly cut in half to serve as take-away containers. They are extremely useful, cheap and generally acceptable. It is even preferred by some customers.

They provide an ideal container when packing (for example) a dozen stubbies, six bottles or for other larger orders.

Larger cartons – the ones that may have been used to deliver a dozen bottles of wine or spirits, or the ones that the casks came in are likewise acceptable for packing bigger orders.

Traditionally wine casks are rarely wrapped while pre-wrapped items, such as spirits in their own presentation boxes, are wrapped.



The keys to effective packing though can be seen as:

- Select the appropriate wrapping paper or bag
- Make sure the wrapper is sound, clean and tidy
- Take a little time and trouble to bag or box the goods. Don't just throw them in as near enough is nowhere near good enough
- Check the way the package looks and don't be afraid to re-do anything that needs attention. Remember that this sends a positive message to the customer 'You are important'
- Hand it over carefully, smile and thank the customer.



Practical gift wrapping

Where gift wrapping is requested make sure you show no signs of annoyance at having to provide this extra service. It is important to avoid sighing, rolling the eyes, or expressing your displeasure in some other way.

If your premises keeps a number of different wrapping papers enquire as to what sort of wrapping is required - what occasion is being celebrated, or is it simply a gift to say 'Thank You'?

The level of gift wrapping provided can vary from the very basic to quite exceptional: in some cases a small charge may be made to cover the items used.

Key points in gift wrapping are:

- Clear a space on which to work – don't try to work on a cluttered, uneven or dirty surface
- Select the correct paper and cut the paper to size ensuring you have sufficient to wrap the items concerned – if you find you don't have enough then start again, don't try to 'make do'
- Fold and wrap the product neatly tucking the tops and bottoms carefully and flat – be prepared to cut off any excess paper that may cause lumps and bulges
- Use sticky tape carefully, don't simply stick it anywhere, anyhow – use it selectively and sparingly in a systematic method
- Add a bow if required, peeling back the adhesive cover from the self-adhesive backing
- Add ribbons if required, tying them neatly and allowing some excess that can be curled using the blade of the scissors drawn quickly along the ribbon
- Present the purchaser with a small gift card for them to complete, and attach this when they have finished writing it
- Give the package carefully to the customer.



Use the wrapping period – it's an opportunity

While wrapping and bagging you may, where you deem it appropriate, use this time to develop a good relationship and rapport with the customer and to engage in some sales talk.

The following may be appropriate under certain circumstances:

- “I see you appreciate a good scotch – next week we’ll be having a new brand in from Scotland that has received some excellent reviews. It’ll be on special till the end of the month.”
- “You obviously know your wines – if you ever want something we don’t usually stock, we’d be more than happy to get it in for you. If you let us know today, we can usually have it in within 3 days, and it would be at our usual competitive price too.”
- “I’m sorry we didn’t have that ‘100 Pipers’ scotch – would you like me to order a few bottles in for you?”
- “That Black Label really is an excellent drop - could I ask if would like us to get anything special in for you in the way of other gifts?”



2.3 Follow safe work practices while packing goods

Introduction

Products need to be safely and securely packed to prevent breakages and to minimise damage to the package itself.

In several instances customers are as much concerned about the container as they are about its contents, especially where the item is a cask of wine, a Special Edition pack or some hard to get and valuable wine.



Pack items safely to prevent any damage in transit

Transit or ‘transportation’ options from the liquor outlet are potentially threefold and they involve:

- The customer taking their goods and getting them home
- The outlet making a home delivery
- The outlet mailing or couriating the items to their destination.



If a customer can rely on us sending their order promptly and rely on it arriving in proper condition, we stand to obtain repeat business and to receive positive word-of-mouth advertising.

Once again, properly preparing a package for transit is just one of those many little things that combine to make up the whole picture of what constitutes ‘excellent professional service’.

Comparing deliveries in to deliveries out

The vast majority of bottles, casks and other liquor products your liquor outlet buys manage to reach you from your suppliers in perfect condition – safe and sound, no breakages, suitable for display and sale.

So it would seem fair to suggest every liquor outlet should be able to duplicate this and send their products to customers safely and securely.



So why is it so hard for many liquor outlets to handle this aspect of customer service?

The main reasons are often traced back to a lack of thought, a lack of proper effort and care in packing the goods, and lack of the right packing materials.

When items are delivered to us they may be shrink-wrapped, tightly packed in full and bottles specific cartons, with appropriate dividers between individual bottles or between layers, and be properly and securely sealed.

The boxes are usually marked as 'Fragile – Glass'.

When we pack our bottles for transit, how does what we do compare to the standard set by our suppliers?

Chances are it leaves a bit to be desired!

The best solution when faced with a continual need to ship bottles is to purchase the appropriate tools for the job in the same way our suppliers do. But this can be expensive and most operators steer away from buying specific cartons, dividers, foam filling, warning labels and proper tape – not all, but most.



The most common, and far cheaper, alternative is to be environmentally friendly and to recycle the boxes and dividers from the goods you have received.

Where a need to re-ship goods has been identified, staff should unpack 'goods in' with care, and with an eye to re-using the packaging that comes with each delivery.

Cartons may be dismantled and folded flat for ease of storage and then re-assembled as required.

Dividers can likewise be stored flat and re-used.

When a delivery is required to be made, the most appropriate carton can then be selected and the order packed using whatever is most suitable for the purpose.

Where a carton is not completely filled with stock, the remaining space may be filled with foam beads, tightly scrunched up newspaper or the folded sides of other cardboard cartons.



Other steps that can increase the likelihood of safe delivery of packages for transit are:

- Notify those handling the cartons that they are fragile – attach appropriate labels or write on the boxes
- Handle the packs carefully at your end so as they are secure, sound and undamaged when they leave you

- Ensure a legible name and address for delivery are readily visible
- Make sure your liquor outlet's name, address and phone number (as the Sender) is readily visible in case the recipient cannot be found so the pack can be returned
- Only use recognised couriers with a good track record
- Tape finished boxes securely to help deter tampering and to prevent the cartons springing open during transit.



Arrange transfer of merchandise for parcel pick up or other delivery methods if required

It may become necessary for you at some stage to arrange the transfer of merchandise for parcel pick-up or other delivery methods as required.

What's involved?

In the vast majority of cases, customers take what they buy with them when they buy it.

Sometimes we may be called on to help carry the purchases to their car. You should always be on the lookout for customers who may need this assistance but may be reluctant to ask for it.

Drive-through venues have relieved people of much of the need to carry goods back to their vehicle, but times and hence opportunities continue to exist where they can still need help.

Drive-in liquor outlets will still require you to stow the purchases in the boot, or on the back seat, as required.

In still other cases, liquor outlet staff will be required to arrange for parcel pick-up or for home delivery to occur. This is another example of providing the customer with a service.

Parcel pick-up

Parcel pick-up is where the customer buys their goods and then returns in their car, sometimes to a nominated 'parcel pick-up point, to pick it up.

Security at parcel pick-up is essential to ensure the right person collects the correct items. We want to avoid giving Customer A the products purchased by Customer B and we want to make sure we don't give anyone items they have not purchased.



To achieve this, documentation is used to match customers to their purchases.

This may be:

- The receipt for the goods purchased
- A parcel pick-up number – this is usually a system where the customer receives a docket or tag with a number on it and the other half of the same-numbered docket is forwarded to parcel pick-up with the goods. To obtain the goods, the customer needs to provide their matching half of the docket.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 2.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to maintain adequate supplies of wrapping materials.
 - 2.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify considerations when pack goods safely.
 - 2.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify types of safe work practices while packing.
-

Summary

Pack goods

Maintain adequate supplies of wrapping materials

- Wrapping materials and bags
- Wrapping options
- Gift wrapping
- New supplies of stock.

Pack goods in a suitably sized bag or container that adequately protects the goods, or wrap goods neatly and effectively

- Customer service
- Gift wrapping
- To bag or to box
- Pre-bagging
- Practical gift wrapping.

Follow safe work practices while packing goods

- Pack items safely to prevent any damage in transit
- Comparing deliveries in to deliveries out
- Arrange transfer of merchandise for parcel pick up or other delivery methods if required.

Element 3: Minimise theft

3.1 Apply security procedures to minimise theft

Introduction

Part of your responsibilities in working in a liquor outlet is to take appropriate action to minimise theft by applying enterprise security procedures.

Exact security practices will vary between outlets and certain aspects of security are a closely guarded secret. When you become aware of these safe-guards and practices you must ensure you don't tell anyone about them.



Where management want the public to know about their security procedures, practices and safe-guards they will take the necessary action to ensure this occurs by erecting posters, signage, etc.

Two central requirements in minimising theft are:

- Taking preventative action to eliminate the incidence of theft – using security equipment, applying security measures, intelligent location of stock and use of security firms and security staff
- Maintaining 'situational awareness' of what is happening in the outlet at all times.

Security firms

Security companies may provide armed cash collection and armed cash delivery services.

This can be a regular service provided 'every night of the week' or may only be used on busy nights, or on a selected basis such as holidays or when banks are closed.

Where they provide cash collection service they pick up money from the store and leave a cheque which the establishment then banks the following day.

Security companies can also provide delivery of wages, and can deliver change when required. This may be useful at times when banks are closed for three days on end due to, say, weekends and public holidays.

Loss Prevention Officers

Many security companies also supply Loss Prevention Officers who are undercover people.

They patrol the store incognito with a view to identifying theft by staff or customers.

The Loss Prevention Officers attend at irregular times, and the people used as officers are changed in order to keep their identity secret.

Static guard services

These are high-profile, uniformed security officers who provide a highly visible presence within the store.

Often positioned near the entrances, their role is to act as a deterrent to both theft and unwelcome behaviour.

Certainly stores that trade after, say, 6:00 PM or 7:00 PM tend to engage static guards to reassure customers their safety and security is being catered for.

It is important that people used in this role understand they are working in a customer service environment and should be friendly and personable individuals as opposed to being intimidating and un-smiling.



Internal security policies and practices

Every outlet is likely to have a raft of policies and procedures relating to theft minimisation. In addition to what has already been presented, these may include:

- Where there are doors the public should not use – such as rear or side access doors, signs must be erected advising the area is private and public admittance is prohibited
- All internal doors that are not used during normal trading activities should be locked and alarmed
- Keeping cash register drawer locked, not just shut but with the keys left in the register, when staff are not in attendance. Remember many thefts occur as a result of a two person operation where one distracts the staff and the other steals the cash or the goods
- Installing security mirrors – and ensuring lines-of-sight are clear and comprehensive and that staff use them
- Installing electronic sensors that sound a buzzer when people walk past them as they enter and leave a store or nominated area
- Using CCTV surveillance – and checking and verifying correct operation at least daily
- Preparing a procedure of what to do in the case of theft and armed robbery for more information regarding preventative action to take regarding armed robberies, and what to do if an armed robbery occurs
- Ensuring appropriate insurance is in place
- Placing only low cost items near entrances – to minimise loss where customers steal stock as they enter, leave or pass by
- Never leaving the store floor unattended at any time – there must always be someone present in the store. If you have to go to the toilet, take an incoming delivery, or deal with any matter you must make sure some takes your place or there is still someone 'on duty' in the area.



Match merchandise to correct price tags

Any liquor outlet will have hundreds of different stock lines and it is part of your job to make sure that each and every item is tagged with the correct price tag.

Failure to ensure this may mean many sales are made of a product at an incorrect (lesser) price or that a loss is made.

It is vital to make sure you match all merchandise to correct price tags every time you place stock in displays or on shelves. There must be no exceptions to this.



Standard procedures

The standard procedures to ensure merchandise is matched to the correct price tags include:

- Visually checking and matching new products to the items already on the shelves to make sure the right item is being placed in the right location
- Reading any existing shelf-talkers, information sheets etc and comparing them to the items to be displayed to make sure correct placement and matching occurs
- Checking delivery documentation to determine cost prices of items and using standard internal protocols to calculate selling price. These standard procedures may include:
 - guide or catalogue
 - Using the selling price as determined and advertised by the Buying Group to which you belong
 - Applying a set formula for calculating selling price – such as multiplying the total cost price for an item by a given percentage, or adding a certain dollar value to this cost
 - Using the recommended selling price as listed in a Product/Purchase order
- Where applicable, scanning the bar code on items and checking the register reading is correct. That is, is as expected and matches the recommended retail price as listed in the appropriate catalogue/list and matches the advertised selling price as listed on the shelf, etc.



Maintain surveillance of merchandise according to enterprise policy

There is a constant need to maintain on-going surveillance of merchandise in liquor outlets at all times.

It must be remembered liquor stores are regular targets for thieves and alcohol is a popular commodity for theft.



Maintaining surveillance

It has already been stated two central requirements in minimising theft are:

- Taking preventative action
- Maintaining 'situational awareness' of what is happening in the outlet at all times.

To prevent theft there is a need to maintain surveillance of stock and the store and this can be effectively achieved by using the following techniques:

- Using mirrors that are located around the store to keep customers and suspicious persons in view
- Investigating electric eye beam, and other, buzzers when they sound – they are designed to notify you that someone has entered a certain area so it is up to you find out why they have activated
- Being alert for suspicious persons entering the liquor outlet area – these may be people who are known to you, people who appear to be loitering, those who glance furtive around to see if they are being watched, those who come in with bags
- Approaching customers and talking to them when they are in the liquor outlet – this can be a great sales aid, but it also lets the customer know that you know they are there and this is a big deterrent to theft
- Being alert to customers switching products – customers may try to put a more expensive product into a cheaper carton or presentation box
- Checking out their trolley – if the customer is wheeling a trolley, it is important to thoroughly check the trolley and look for other products that may be ‘forgotten’ somewhere amongst the other shopping, or at the bottom of the trolley, commonly out of easy sight from behind the counter.



3.2 Maintain security of cash in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

Whilst a lot of security practices, policies and procedures will be centred around the protection of cash, although it is extremely important, there are other areas of a liquor outlet that must also be protected.

The previous section explored some of these areas. This section will examine other areas in more detail.

In Section 1 of this manual, a number of cash security activities, mainly in relation to cash register operations were detailed.

Part of the security tasks required of you when working in a liquor outlet is to maintain the security of stock, cash, and equipment in relation to customers, staff and outside contractors.

This orientation recognises anyone who enters the liquor outlet area has the potential to steal stock, cash, or equipment. We must always be aware that liquor outlets contain two items that are highly prized by thieves – cash and liquor – and they are always on the lookout for opportunities to steal.

Personal observation of what is happening coupled with ‘reading’ of people and situations is the most effective way to maintain security of items, cash, etc.



Maintain security of stock, cash and equipment in relation to customers, staff and outside contractors

It must be said that, though a thief may look like our perception of a thief, they can be people we would never in a million years suspect of theft.

Looking innocent, harmless, and virtuous is an effective cloak that many criminals wear very well to lull workers into thinking they do not pose a threat.



If theft does occur, it is beneficial to have effective insurance in place – it will be management's task to put such coverage into place.

Inspection of the venue by security companies to highlight establishment-specific problems in relation to theft may also be undertaken.

The police will also supply a similar service. The key in relation to security is prevention is always better than cure.

High risk pilferage areas

Experience has identified there are certain high-risk areas for theft in a liquor store:



- Certain product lines – these are the popular brands and lines of spirits as well as new releases and products that are part of a competition. These are always a target for theft wherever the products are
- Near entry and exit doors are a traditional problem area – it is relatively easy for thieves to duck inside the door, grab an item and run away. It is for this reason that low cost products and items with a low attraction rate are usually stocked in this location
- Be aware of – and try to eliminate – any internal area that provides 'cover' (blind spots, corner areas) for the customer from the eyes of staff. Mirrors are useful deterrents in this situation and provide excellent detection tools
- Cool rooms – cool rooms provide an excellent and sometimes secluded spot for thieves to put bottles or cans 'up their jumper', in their bag, inside other shopping, or in their coat.

Equipment

These notes indicate that cash, beverages, snack items and confectionery are the most 'at risk' items in a liquor outlet, but we must also remember that, to some people, the lure of stealing or intentionally damaging equipment may be their prime goal.

Their aim may be to steal bottle and wine openers, or – less likely – point-of-sale and other operational pieces of equipment.

This may include:

- Labelling and pricing guns
- Promotional displays
- Beverage tasting equipment
- Lifting devices, forklifts and trolleys.



As with other aspects of loss prevention, constant watchfulness is the key, coupled with the realisation anyone could steal or intentionally damage anything.

This orientation also applies to contractors and sub-contractors who attend at the liquor outlet to deliver various services. Many of these personnel are given free run of the premises, and have unsupervised access to, and plenty of time in, areas that may normally be classified as 'secure' or restricted.

This understanding highlights the need for you to 'keep an eye' on these people too. A regular 'walk through' where they are working, deliberate observation of their activities or notification that it is standard operating procedure for their bags or toolboxes to be inspected prior to departure may be of benefit.

In some circumstances, a security officer may be charged with watching them or accompanying them at all times.

3.3 Deal with suspicious behaviour of customers and/or staff in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

While working in the liquor outlet it is expected that you will make a conscious effort to identify and observe any suspicious behaviour by customers and respond in accordance with enterprise policy.

This is obviously a key element in minimising theft and preventing unwanted behaviour in the store.

What is suspicious behaviour?

Suspicious behaviour may include:

- People looking anxious – especially when you look at them, approach them, or talk to them
- People spending a lot of time in the liquor outlet but not buying anything – it should be standard policy to approach customers who fall into this category and make an offer of assistance. The very fact you have spoken to them often serves as a deterrent to them actually stealing something
- People who look around furtively
- People who become aggressive when you approach them with an offer of help
- Anyone who enters the liquor outlet wearing a motorcycle helmet – unless it's a drive-in liquor outlet and they're riding a motor bike
- People who come in with a large bag or a bulky overcoat
- New customers who come in regularly and make small purchases after spending a deal of time looking around – these people may be totally innocent but they may be casing the place for a future robbery.



Check your house policies about suspicious behaviour and suspicious persons and talk to management at your workplace to find out who they have identified as potential thieves, based on their experience in that location.

It may be standard operating procedure to:

- Report all suspicious persons to management
- Approach suspicious customers, greet them and make a service offer (“Good morning, how are you today? What can I help you with today?”). This customer-focused activity often has the desired effect of getting the suspicious person to move on
- It is a non-negotiable requirement you never put yourself in harm’s way when dealing with a suspicious person
- It may be a requirement to complete an Incidents Register if you detect what you believe to be a suspicious person – describing them, the vehicle they left in, etc.
- Where a dangerous situation arises, the police may be called to assist in removing the person. Most businesses prefer management contact police rather than staff – find out what applies in your store and adhere to it.



Deal with suspicious packages

Not only is it suspicious people that a staff member must be aware of. In some cases suspicious packages may also be present, which must be handled in the most appropriate and safest manner.

Any items handed in to service staff, for example, items found by staff or customers, must be checked to ensure they not only are they not dangerous or illegal, but that they are not suspicious in nature.

Certainly, today, many establishments are more aware of the possibility of terrorist activity than ever before.

This means that staff should be aware of any packages that are left lying around, unattended or are in a place that they should not be, and hence will raise suspicion.

Again, err on the side of caution, and don’t be afraid of getting a supervisor or manager involved in the situation.

Where a suspicious package is identified, the appropriate response is:

- Do not touch it
- Phone the police and report the finding; stay on the line until told to hang up; answer the questions asked to the best of your ability
- Leave the package in the place where it was discovered
- Evacuate people from the immediate area – you may elect to evacuate people from a wider area depending on the nature of what it is you have found
- Turn off anything that is likely to trigger an explosion, such as mobile phones.



There is no such thing as a definition of a suspicious package. Many, many items that do not look suspicious have in fact concealed a device that has exploded.

Certainly there are indications a package may conceal a device – and experts know what to look for. The problem however is that if we examine a package and believe it has no tell-tale signs it is a bomb, we may then move it and by so doing, detonate it.

It is for this reason these notes have deliberately omitted information about what signs to look for. Treat every suspicious package with the utmost care and respect and follow the advice given above.

When the Police have been notified they will attend and assist with evacuation, as well as determining which other services should be called in. Options may include the Hazardous Materials squad, Bomb Disposal, the Army, or Special Operations.

Whilst we don't want to over-react to suspicious package situations, it is important to make the decision relatively quickly about whether or not 'a situation' exists. Commonly, individuals are reluctant to contact authorities in case there is not a problem, and they think they will then be made to look foolish – you must overcome this thought. It really is a case of being better safe than sorry.

3.4 Keep storage areas secure from unauthorised access in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

In previous sections, a range of security measures have been identified to help minimise the damage or theft of many valuable items contained in a liquor store.

This section will focus on the protection of items found in storage areas.

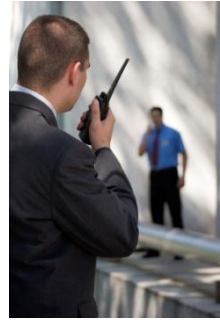
Storeroom controls

The following are generally applicable controls that may be applied to liquor outlets, or any area where tempting and valuable stock is held:

- Access to the stores area must be restricted both in terms of establishment personnel with permission to enter, and times they are allowed there. Many establishments restrict access to stores area to a few select staff rather than allowing all and sundry to enter
- In addition, some premises will only permit staff to access stores areas at limited times during the day. Whenever a person from another business needs to enter the back-of-house areas. These may be delivery drivers or service technician. It is standard practice to accompany them at all times to deter them from stealing
- No stock items should move in or out of the liquor outlet area unless accompanied by correctly completed supporting paperwork. The liquor outlet is frequently the 'central store' for beverages for the rest of the property, where that property is a hotel or club



- This means bars, dining rooms, and even housekeeping will access their liquor and other drinks from the liquor outlet. In order to facilitate effective stock control, and prevent theft, you must ensure no stock at all leaves the liquor outlet area unless it is accompanied by the necessary, and properly signed, requisition or internal stock transfer sheet
- Video surveillance (closed circuit television – CCTV) may be employed using high profile camera domes or cameras to advertise that areas are under surveillance
- Regular internal security patrols – these are high profile anti-theft activities that management can undertake, sending a clear signal the outlet is security aware
- Locks should be used on doors and key access limited – where stock is stored in any room or cupboard, there locks should be fitted to the doors and only key personnel given access to the keys
- It is not common for liquor outlets to use EAS (Electronic Article Surveillance) measures. These include electronic tags which alarm when passed through detection barriers at the door of the outlet.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 3.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify types of security procedures to minimise theft.
 - 3.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to maintain security of cash.
 - 3.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to deal with suspicious behaviour of customers and/or staff.
 - 3.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to keep storage areas secure from unauthorised access.
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Summary

Minimise theft

Apply security procedures to minimise theft

- Security firms
- Loss Prevention Officers
- Static guard services
- Internal security policies and practice
- Match merchandise to correct price tags
- Maintain surveillance of merchandise according to enterprise policy.

Maintain security of cash in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Maintain security of stock, cash and equipment in relation to customers, staff and outside contractors.

Deal with suspicious behaviour of customers and/or staff in accordance with enterprise procedures

- What is suspicious behaviour?
- Deal with suspicious packages.

Keep storage areas secure from unauthorised access in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Storeroom controls.

Element 4: Merchandise goods

4.1 Receive, unpack and store goods in appropriate location

Introduction

A regular job within a liquor outlet is the unpacking of merchandise and its storage in appropriate locations.

Deliveries made to liquor outlets will always need to be stored promptly.

Some stock will need to be unpacked for immediate display either on shelves, fixtures, displays or other point-of-sale promotions, and some stock may need to be stored back-of-house for later use.



Where might stock need to be placed?

Stock delivered into the premises may be stored:

- In the coolroom – which is the normal place for beers, ciders and stouts, some ready-to-drink lines, some white and sparkling wines, and some soft drink
- On the floor – merchandising plans produced by the store (or head office) can require stock to be positioned directly onto the floor as part of a ‘selling by seeing’ display, or as part of some other promotion designed to create interest and increase sales
- In a store room – deliveries may need to be taken to an adjacent storage room where reserve stock of items such as spirits, fortifieds, wines and liqueurs are kept
- By delivering stock directly to other departments – where the liquor outlet is part of a large venue, it is usual for it to be the central store for liquor and beverages.



In this situation, all beverage deliveries (with the exception of draught beer (kegs) and other bulk lines (such as post-mix) are made to the liquor outlet, and the liquor outlet distributes items to departments as requested on internal requisition sheets.

Commonly a delivery may require part of the order to go to the cool room, part to be displayed ‘on the floor’, part to go to the bars, and part to go to the store room.

Stock may be stored in the carton in which it was delivered or it may be unpacked and stored on shelves or ‘bins’. It is always important to quickly determine where the newly delivered stock is to be stored so as to save time and double-handling, and to maximise stock security and customer safety.

Unpacking deliveries

When unpacking deliveries the following points are commonly applied:

- Check the delivery against the accompanying documentation to ensure all the stated stock has been received. Your check should involve verifying quantities, brand names, quality indicators such as vintages, number of stars, correct label colour and the size of the items
- Ensure you sign for the delivery as acknowledgment it has been delivered in accordance with the accompanying paperwork - all deliveries must be signed for
- Check the condition of the product – you must ensure all the incoming stock is in a saleable condition. This means the label must be in good repair, the packaging is not damaged, seals are intact and there is no leakage, bottles are filled to the required levels, and nothing is floating in the contents that shouldn't be there
- Ensure the presence of the stock on the floor does not present an OSH hazard – position stock so it doesn't impede traffic flow and cause a tripping hazard
- Don't leave stock unattended – if you have items lying around, there is always the chance that someone will help themselves
- Dispose of cartons, dividers and packaging material properly – this includes keeping the area tidy when unpacking stock, and also highlights the need to be environmentally sensitive
- Be careful – unpacking stock is a traditional time when bottles are broken. We may accidentally drop them, knock them together or even drop a carton
- Apply correct manual handling and safe lifting techniques when storing and displaying stock.



Customer service

You must always remember when unpacking and storing merchandise that the customer comes first.

You must stop your unpacking and storage activities to assist or serve a customer – the customer takes priority. They are not an interruption to your work; they are the reason for it.

The customer must always be the prime focus - if you don't serve them, they'll go somewhere else and someone else will serve them.

Customers must be your priority – they are so easy to lose, and so very hard, if not impossible, to win back.



Practise safe lifting, shifting and handling procedures to comply with OSH regulations

Management is required under OSH requirements to provide safe working conditions for staff and to provide necessary equipment to assist staff work safely.

Their responsibility extends to training staff in safe manual handling practices and supervising their actions.

Manual handling

The majority of workplace injuries are caused by incorrect manual handling procedures so you need to take care when lifting and handling cartons of stock, slabs of beer and moving display fixtures and fittings.



Manual handling is any activity requiring the use of force by a person to lift, push, pull, carry or otherwise move or restrain any object.

This definition certainly involves the lifting, carrying and moving of stock in a liquor outlet.

In the past, traditional approaches to controlling manual handling risks tended to focus on setting weight limits for lifting, and training staff in correct lifting techniques. These measures alone proved to be inadequate in reducing the number and severity of injuries.

There are many factors, other than the weight of objects, which contribute to the risk of manual handling injury.

Other factors which impact on the overall safety of the activity include the layout of the workplace, the skill and experience of the staff, posture, the duration and frequency of the activity, and work organisation. All play a part in workplace safety in terms of manual handling.

Standard current practice requires all manual handling tasks to be examined, and assessed before they are undertaken. Where tasks are assessed as a risk, the risk must be controlled.

Employers, supervisors and staff all have responsibilities and a role to play in the elimination and reduction of workplace risks.

Workplace layout

Attention must be paid to layout issues which may pose a hazard in relation to manual handling such as:

- Narrow doorways and walkways
- Lack of space in which to work, operate or move
- Steps or raised areas in the floor.



Mechanical aids and trolleys should only be used where there is sufficient space to use them safely, and where appropriate storage space for them exists.

If there is inadequate storage for them, then they can become a safety hazard in their own right through being stored in walkways, further restricting access and blocking exits.

Work practices

Each job may be made up of a number of manual handling tasks. The amount of manual handling done by each staff member, and the total amount of manual handling, may be able to be reduced by redesign of jobs and tasks, and redesigning work-flow.

The redesign of work-flow and work practices may mean changing the timing of deliveries in, and re-stocking, so other staff are present to assist. Repetition of a manual handling task, not just the weight that is involved, may be a factor to consider, and avoid as appropriate.

This may also include consideration of removing, as far as possible, double-handling.

Reducing the force needed to move items also reduces the risk of injuries. This means the load to be lifted should be at the appropriate height (which is around waist height) and this may necessitate the redesign of storage areas frequently used, or heavy objects are stored at a safe height and able to be easily reached without stretching.



Action should be taken to reduce or eliminate the amount of bending, forward reaching and twisting required when performing manual handling tasks. Action should be taken to modify or redesign the work layout, in addition to what has been listed above, to ensure there is sufficient space to move or use equipment that can reduce bending, reaching and twisting actions.

Avoid, wherever possible, reaching and twisting to hold doors open while you push trolleys through or carry cartons.

Trolleys with castors made of polyurethane or hard rubber require less force to move than those with softer, rounder tyres such as pneumatic or soft rubber.

Where a floor surface is soft, like carpet, the use of wide wheels or additional wheels may reduce the force needed to move them. The harder and smoother the floor surface is, the less resistance there is to wheels and castors.

Appropriate clothing should be worn when performing manual handling.

Clothing should allow unrestricted movement, and footwear should be non-slip and provide adequate stability.

Manual handling aids

The use of manual handling aids can be very effective in reducing manual handling injuries to staff.

In liquor outlets commonly used manual handling aids include:

- Trolleys
- Forklifts – a licence is required to operate these
- Hand pallet trucks.



As advised fork lift operators are required to have a current and appropriate licence to operate this item of equipment. You may be very competent with a fork lift but unless you have the required licence you are not permitted by law to operate one.

Forklifts are dangerous pieces of equipment and have killed people in the workplace.

Training

The employer is required to provide necessary training to employees, but training alone is not seen as enough to satisfy all the OSH requirements. Supervision, risk analysis and control, proper personal protective equipment, audits and a collaborative approach to workplace safety are also required.



This means that staff need to be supervised during and after training to ensure they are performing their duties in accord with OSH demands.

Simply showing someone how to do something and then leaving them on their own to get on with it is not acceptable.

Suggested safe lifting and carrying tips

The present orientation to safe manual handling does not mandate safe lifting techniques.

As we have seen, the legislation prefers to eliminate or reduce manual handling in favour of other options.

To reinforce previous notes, there are no legislated maximum weight limits in relation to what staff can be asked or required to lift.

This said, in a liquor outlet, some lifting always has to be done – even if it is lifting a carton onto a trolley that will be used to move the purchase to the customer's car.

To reduce the potential of injuries, the following steps are offered for your consideration. They are generally recognised as providing an acceptable sequence of actions when faced with a lifting and carrying decision:

- Do a quick assessment of what needs to be lifted – is it:
 - Too heavy to lift?
 - Too awkward?
 - Too slippery?
 - Too hot, too cold?
 - Too dangerous in any way?
 - How far has it got to be carried?
 - What hazards or obstacles are involved along the route the item has to be carried?
- If any of the above apply then either get help (for a team lift), or reject the option of lifting it and use a mechanical aid. Never attempt a lift if you are not 200% sure it can be done safely. Your employer would prefer to arrange another option than to have you injured
- If you decide you can lift the item safely on your own, follow these steps:
 - Place your feet apart, one foot beside the load, one foot behind it
 - Bend your knees
 - Hold the load firmly with both hands
 - Raise your head and tuck your chin in to keep your back straight
 - Lift load to the waist, by straightening your legs, keeping elbows close to the body

- To put the load down, bend your knees and keep your back straight
- Wear protective clothing when necessary.

4.2 Display stock in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

The way merchandise is displayed is very much an individual premises concern.

There will be certain similarities in stock display and lay-out between a large number of stores, but there will also be plenty of individual differences based on store size, internal traffic flow patterns, personal management preferences and experience.



Important keys for you are to:

- Follow house requirements
- Ensure safety of customers and staff
- Optimise security of the items being displayed.

Display merchandise to achieve a balanced fully stocked appearance and promote sales

The display and lay-out of stock in a drive-in will be fundamentally different to that in a walk-in facility simply due to the differing nature of both outlets.

Many walk-in stores will place fast moving lines featuring high volume sellers such as beer at the back of the store requiring the customers to walk through the store to make their purchase.



The hope is customers will notice displays and other stock as they walk through, and make an 'impulse buy'.

An impulse buy is a purchase made on-the-spot, a purchase they had not intended to make on entering the store.

In some cases, the coolroom is at the back of the store simply to facilitate re-stocking through a rear entry, or because it makes best use of available space by locating it there.

The location of stock within the store may be dictated in part by traffic flow in the following way. High traffic areas generate what are known in the trade as 'hot spots', whilst low traffic areas produce 'cold spots'. Areas with medium traffic flow generate 'warm areas'.

Areas near the cash register, the front entrance, and the walk-in cool room entrances are traditional hot spots.

Areas in corners and at the extremities are cold spots.

The warm areas may be the middle of the store.

Merchandising – shelves and displays

Prime positions

Stock in liquor outlets is traditionally stored in cool rooms, on the floor or on shelves.

In some cases special displays may be created to generate sales, to conform with or take advantage of a special multi-media promotional campaign, or simply to provide a point of interest – a talking point – amongst your regulars.



When arranging stock on a shelf, or when producing a display, you should be aware the best retail position for products, be that in hot, cold or warm spots, is in any location that provides the highest profile and visibility. This is usually the area at eye level and down to hip level.

Stock in this range tends to be more readily seen by customers than stock placed on high shelf levels, or stock placed on the floor.

This concept explains why stock placed on the floor generally has some point-of-sale advertising material at eye level, intended to draw the customer's attention down to the floor level stock.

Popular lines are usually displayed within this range to facilitate customer selection.

Facings

'Facings' is an industry term referring to the number of exposures an item receives on the shelf or in a display. It is the number of times the product faces the customer.

Any store has a finite amount of shelf space, so care must be taken when deciding facings for any product. In practice, a higher number of facings are allocated to high turnover stock whilst items with lower turnover receive fewer facings and less shelf space.



A product may have four facings, meaning that four bottles of the product are facing the customer on the shelf, and the shelf may accommodate stock three-deep. This means there are twelve bottles on display for sale.

Part of your on-going store housekeeping is to move stock forward as sales occur. This movement of stock to the front of shelves or the replenishment of stock from a store room is done to help present a 'full' look to the public indicating you have plenty of stock and are not a business likely to run out of stock.

It also helps to present a tidier and neater store face to the public. Shelves that are full – that is with all facings occupied – look more attractive and can make it easier for the customer to look at our range of stock and make their selections.

Groupings

Products can be grouped in a variety of ways.

There are no legal requirements about what must be grouped with what, although premises which are part of a group or chain may be under instructions from Head Office about what to group with what. In other instances, groupings are the result of individual management preference, experience and store layout and display space available.

Traditionally, products are grouped by:

- Product type
- Specials
- Size.

Product type

This is the most common method used. It means, for example, spirits are displayed in the one area, with all scotches grouped together, all rums grouped with each other, all vodkas grouped with the other vodkas and so on.

Liqueurs are grouped together, and red wines grouped with other red wines, fortified wines are kept together, as are whites and sparkling wines.



Beers, white wines, cider and ready-to-drink lines are usually grouped in the cool room, grouped in terms of their location behind display doors, and in the cool room proper.

Domestic beers are grouped together, near but distinct from imported lines: soft drinks may be grouped in a separate self-contained fridge.

Spirits will also often group full bottles and half bottles together.

Liqueurs too, will also have full and half bottles of the same brand next to each other.

Specials

The premises may have one or several specials areas. These areas can be distinct or separate specials area, or they can be dispersed throughout the store amongst other non-special lines.

The specials for wines, for instance, may be adjacent to your normal wine stock. The spirit specials may be near the cash register, next to your normal spirit shelves or near the cool room entrance.

Packs of ready-to-drink products may be located on the floor near their refrigerated counterparts in the cool room.

Size

It is common for all miniatures (50ml) to be displayed together, and for all flasks (150ml) to be kept together, but this is not always the case. Stores may display miniatures and flasks behind the service counter to help reduce the chance of these small and relatively easy to steal items.

Many premises will also group all casks together despite their size differences, ranging generally from 2 litres, 3 litres, 4 litres etc.

Displays

A display will usually comprise samples of the product on offer, together with another item or article ('props') that links to the product such as a glass, an opener, a book, a decanter, a barrel, and a selling price ticket which may or may not also include the savings that this price represents.

Displays created within a store are designed to:

- Increase sales
- Make purchasing quicker and easier for the customers
- Generate impulse sales
- Create consumer interest
- Capitalise on an up-coming special event
- Highlight an individual product, or set of products
- Provide a tasting opportunity and forum
- Add interest to the store and produce an environment where things are always changing and something's always going on – the store is a fun place to visit compared to the opposition.



Display requirements

All displays should look neat and tidy, clean, attractive and enticing, balanced and full of stock.

This means only quality, undamaged stock should be displayed - items in or on the displays must be presentable, of saleable condition, free of rips and tears, free of dents and crush marks, free of finger marks, and not soiled in any way.

Displays should also fit in with any image that your store seeks to create in the minds of the public and your clientele.

Many promotions can be seen to be pushing the bounds of decency, and you must determine whether or not participating in such promotions by using the attendant point-of-sales posters or DVDs is appropriate for you. It may be your customer base will find such advertising material offensive.

Merchandising

Merchandising professionals, who are experts in creating displays, operate with three fundamentals in mind when designing any display.

We should bear these principles in mind when we attempt to establish any display, but bear in mind that being able to produce attractive and effective displays is a real art, and may take a bit of practice. Some people seem to have a flair for it, and some struggle.

The experts consider Focus, Balance and the use of triangular configurations and outlines when putting a display together. Note this approach is general in nature, and many effective displays can be built that ignore and almost seem to contradict, these concepts.

You need to know what it is you are going to promote, and determine the location in which you will place the display. Working this out first will set parameters for you in terms of how much room you have, what the surrounding environment is like, traffic patterns, security concerns, lighting and exposure to the sun, the public, noise and other environmental considerations.

Within this positional orientation to focus is the need for you to identify what will be the precise focus (there is usually only one focus per display) of the display.

This answers the question “What are we going to do to draw the attention of the customer to this display?” This focus can be achieved by variations in the use of colour, lighting, circles, different sizes, space, movement and sound. This may mean you use a flashing light, a video, an eye-catching poster, a person conducting tastings, a compressed air operated figurine, a turn-table, music, or an informative DVD.

Lighting is not so much a concern in drive-ins but the use of different lighting, in-store, can produce results. Displays may be enhanced by the creative use of coloured lights, spot lights, flashing lights, and other track-mounted and hence relatively mobile lighting.

Balance

Any display should be balanced in order for it to look appealing and attractive.

Balance refers to the overall look of the display, and the experts select from three options:

- Symmetry, asymmetry and a combination of these two
- Symmetry is where the display is equal on both sides
- Asymmetry is where one side is more pronounced than the other.



The combination option combines these two but still produces a balanced looking display.

Displays that are not balanced can turn customers away, or at least be less attractive and enticing than balanced ones. They can send a “couldn’t care less” attitude and the impression the display has just been hurriedly thrown together with no thought and with no concern for the customer.

Triangles

In theory, using a triangular shape, as the basis for a display is regarded as providing the display with a sense of cohesion and permanence, as well as supporting the concept of symmetry.

Note that attempting to create a display that fits within the constructs of a triangular shape need only be an approximate thing. There is no requirement for every item to fit within the triangle. Small parts can project beyond the imaginary lines. Likewise there is no requirement for all the internal space to be occupied. There can be some gaps, however it is generally accepted that the more effective displays tend to group the items in the display fairly tightly together.

Make it a practice to notice what other stores do in terms of their displays, and start keeping a file of cuttings from magazines and papers that illustrate different promotional displays. You might even try and photograph what others are doing and start an album.

Talk to your suppliers and ask them what assistance they can provide in terms of ideas and practical in-store production of displays. Many suppliers have excellent ideas and plenty of supporting material to help build your displays.

Many outlets develop a promotional calendar for their store. This is a calendar that looks twelve months ahead and identifies all the events that could provide the basis for a special promotion – these events may be traditional ones such as Valentine's Day, St Patrick's Day, and Christmas, or they can include other local and sporting events.

Developing this calendar enables you to better plan for your displays. Displays can be hard work and they definitely don't 'just happen' so the more you can prepare and organise for them, the better.

Many trade magazines will contain this sort of calendar which highlights and explains various promotions that different suppliers intend to run. They will inform you of the media campaigns when they will run, and in which media, any competitions or give-aways that are involved, quantity inducements and point-of-sale promotional material that may be available.

Linking in with this sort of promotion is good business. Someone else is spending the advertising dollars, and you are simply riding off the back of the campaign.

Before you begin to create displays of your own, make sure you check with management first to identify any guidelines they may have, and any tips they can provide.

An overview on displays

Shelf Stock

1. Group all similar products together
2. Increase facings for high demand items
3. Use shelf tickets for new products and items
4. Adjust stock facings to match differences in seasonal demand
5. Maintain a 'full shelf' appearance to:
 - Give a full appearance
 - Ensure stock is correctly rotated – check dates on reserve cartons when loading
 - Shelves to see that old stock is sold first. The system used to rotate stock is 'First In, First Out'.



Floor Displays

Effective displays will create bigger sales.

1. Locate items you want to sell in hot spots
2. If practical locate high demand products at the back of the store
3. Maintain appearance:
 - Discard used and empty cartons
 - Use dummy cartons to bolster displays



- Make sure all displays have a price tag for the products
 - Up-date displays one-at-a-time
4. Group similar products
 5. Re-stock as required

4.3 Create and/or dismantle special promotional displays

Introduction

The last section explored some considerations when creating displays.

All displays or special promotions will need to be reset and dismantled from time-to-time.

No displays or promotions are ever 'set and forget'.

Whenever doing re-sets or dismantling displays follow all OSH requirements and ensure customer service is a priority. Always walk away from re-setting a display or dismantling it to serve a customer.

Re-setting a display

Resetting a display or sales promotion may involve:

- Re-stocking it as customers buy the products
- Moving it to a different physical location within the store
- Replenishing promotional material that is part of the display
- Changing the stock in the physical display – that is, retaining the display itself but altering the product lines within the display. For example shifting the display from one which promoted vodka to one that now promotes bourbon
- Changing one or more aspects of the original display to respond to customer comments or complaints and to capitalise on what is proving to be a popular promotion.



When you do re-set a display or promotion, timing is important.

It is not advisable to do it during recognised busy periods as that time must be allocated to customer service.

Displays are usually reset and initially created during whatever your quiet times are. These will vary between premises but are commonly early morning and early to mid afternoon.

In some cases you may have no choice but to do your re-sets and display creation and dismantling before you open or after you close to ensure customer safety and to avoid interrupting normal trade.

Dismantling displays

When a display or promotion has 'finished' it will need to be dismantled.

Dismantling may occur when a nominated date has arrived or when the display or promotion has achieved the objective it was intended to achieve.

Factors to consider when dismantling a display or promotion include:

- Minimising interruption to customers – this means undertaking the dismantling in quiet times or when the store is closed
- Ensuring customer safety – by making sure no tripping or other hazards are present
- Dismantling one display at a time – to retain the presence of other displays within the store
- Working carefully – to prevent damage to stock and equipment
- Returning stock to other appropriate other locations including shelves or the store room – and completing appropriate internal documentation, where needed, to track the movement of this stock
- Retaining materials used in the display or promotion – so they can be re-used in subsequent displays, etc.
- Maintaining a clean and tidy store appearance.



4.4 Keep displays clean and tidy

Introduction

All display areas must be kept clean and tidy so as to send a message to customers that we are caring professionals, who take pride in our work and value our customers.

Constant vigilance and follow-up action are the keys to keeping displays and store areas clean and tidy.

If you see something requiring cleaning, tidying or other attention you must do something about it. Never leave someone else to fix the problem.

Cleaning and tidying duties

Cleaning and tidying maintains the appearance of the premises and encourages business.

Keeping areas tidy is also a prime OSH requirement in that it reduces the possibility of people tripping over stock or other items left lying around.

Keeping areas clean and tidy includes:

- Performing routine dusting, polishing and vacuuming – the cleaning schedule for the workplace will identify many of these tasks but the reality is there will always be extra tasks that have to be undertaken



- Performing spot cleaning and cleaning up spills and breakages as required during trade
- Taking a walk outside and ensuring the exterior of the premises is clean and tidy – papers will blow into your area, people will drop rubbish etc and all this detracts from the image we are seeing to create. Take a moment to look at the drive-in roadway and footpaths and sweep and wash it as required. This may be something that has to be done many times per day
- Putting equipment away when you have finished using it, including trolleys, cartons, cleaning equipment, and display material. If you notice you are running short of cleaning chemicals, take steps to re-order them
- Removing packaging and promotional signs that are no longer wanted or which are out of date
- Monitoring stock and displays – to ensure everything has eye appeal and hasn't started to look tired and shabby
- Replacing things that need replacing – blown light globes, flickering fluorescent tubes, cracked plastic advertising signage, torn or dog-eared posters, window-mounted signs that have started to fall off, empty boxes.



Check with your supervisor to find out where the necessary cleaning equipment is stored, and get some instruction in how to use it if you don't know. Remember to put it away as soon as you've finished using it.

Be careful about electrical leads and extension cords lying around the place that could present a tripping hazard.

Make sure customer service remains a priority. Never keep cleaning and tidying when there is a customer to be served - they always come first.

Ensure cleanliness of refrigerators and coolrooms

In all areas of the liquor outlet cleanliness should be a watch-word.

Customers expect and appreciate clean and tidy premises. It helps to send all the right sorts of messages about hygiene and customer service.

Standard practice is to clean the premises, refrigerators and coolrooms when the business is closed and there are no customers present.

What applies?

The entire store must be maintained in a clean and tidy condition and this idea must extend to all the refrigerators in the liquor outlet and to the coolroom too.

These areas are sometimes missed when the cleaning is done, simply because their floor area (and shelving) is behind a closed door. The use of a proper cleaning schedule will ensure these items of equipment are cleaned thoroughly and cleaned when required.

In addition to the actual cleaning required by a cleaning schedule, you must conduct regular inspections of these items throughout the trading day to identify whether or not additional cleaning is required.



For instance, if a customer drops a bottle or carton on the floor of the liquor outlet we are bound to hear and see it. However, if they do the same in the coolroom there is a chance we may not hear it or see it, but the mess still remains to serve as a hazard, and to potentially damage other stock as well.

People who drop bottles or damage stock, even accidentally, won't always let us know what's happened. Perhaps they're scared we'll charge them for what they've broken, maybe they're too embarrassed, or maybe they just feel guilty.



Where broken glass is detected and liquid is lying on the floor, you must take immediate action to clean the area and make it safe. Your premises will have warning signs to erect when such a situation has been identified so you'll need to know where to find these, and the necessary equipment to clean up the mess.

Preventative 'maintenance'

In addition to the above there may be preventative cleaning procedures you can undertake to help extend the effective life of refrigeration items and to lengthen the time between service calls.

Cleaning is a prime preventative maintenance activity so get management to show you what cleaning you can perform to help the cool room and other refrigeration items run more effectively, and cost less to operate.

It is standard industry practice not to cut cartons in the coolroom so as to prevent airborne particles clogging the evaporators.

Check your house policy or standard operating procedure for further direction. If nothing exists – ask management.

Maintain the correct temperature of display refrigerators and coolrooms so that all products are kept at recommended temperatures

Whilst you are not expected to be a fully trained refrigeration mechanic, you are expected to keep an eye on the refrigeration and identify when it is not working properly.

This means you must be aware of the standard operating temperatures of all refrigeration units used in your workplace.

Applicable temperatures

Coolrooms used to store liquor products will usually operate within the 2°C to 4°C range.

Liquor outlets in hot climates will run even lower, sometimes close to 0°C, sometimes requiring the coolroom to have a defrost cycle.

Correct temperature is very important because customers demand their beer, cider and white wines to be cold, very cold.

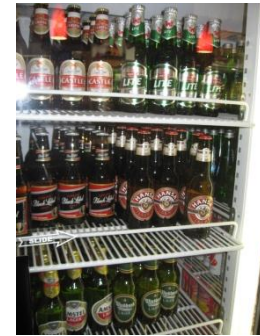
You must never adjust the temperature of any unit unless specifically instructed to do so by management.

Did you know that most of the glass display doors in these walk-in cool rooms are fitted with heating elements to stop the glass fogging up?

Find out what temperature your cool rooms run at, and find out how to tell what it is running at - a visual display gauge or an LCD read-out is common.

As mentioned earlier you should ask the name of the commercial refrigeration your employer uses, and get their phone number for future reference so you can contact them if there is a need to do so.

Other refrigeration units in the liquor outlet include free standing display units. These are traditionally supplied by the drink supplier and there is often a requirement you only keep their product lines in their fridges.



Once again, find out what temperature they operate at, how you can determine what it actually is running at, and who you should call if there is a problem. The company that services your coolroom may not be the one that repairs the self-contained units.

An independent probe thermometer (properly calibrated) can be used to take the temperature of all the refrigeration units.

In addition, the liquor outlet may be air-conditioned. If this is the case it is advisable to find out what settings are normally used, and how to operate the unit.

Yet again, because the air conditioning is going to affect the temperature of all your 'room temperature' stock, it is useful to know who services it when required.

4.5 Rotate stock in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

All stock in a liquor outlet must be rotated on a regular basis.

Stock rotation is necessary to sell stock before 'best before' dates are exceeded and so as to keep stock current.

Stock rotation principles

The vast majority of stock in a liquor store will be rotated on a First In, First Out basis. This is also known as FIFO.

This means when new stock arrives, the old stock is sold before the new stock.

This requires you to move old stock forward to the front of shelves, displays, self-contained units or cool room doors, ensuring old supplies in the store are sold before new stock is offered for sale.



The only situation where FIFO principles are not adhered to could be where the premises purchases a stock of wines which it wants to 'lay down' for ageing and sale many years into the future.

Practical considerations

Points to note in relation to stock rotation are:

- Make sure you know which wines (if any) have been bought in with the specific intent of laying them down and then selling them later when they have aged. Management will not want you to sell these until the wines have received sufficient age
- Rotate wine casks using their 'Best Before' dates, or their filling date as the basis for rotation
- Distribute any out-of-date (or close to 'Best Before' date) stock to bars (where possible) so it can be used for dispensing purposes
- Sell all products with a dated label or 'worn' appearance before new stock is offered for sale
- Rotate stock so as to present shelves and displays with a 'fully stocked' appearance
- Check non-liquor items – chips, nuts, and confectionery lines – too: again, be mindful of
- Best Before dates and either promote them or return to suppliers (as appropriate).



Consider changing in-store layout

In addition to rotating stock so as to align with FIFO principles, you may wish to periodically rotate the physical location of stock within the premises.

Whilst this may annoy some customers who have become familiar with your layout, it can also generate a bit of interest and may create additional sales as people notice for the first time lines that they previously did not know you carried.

Any store that never changes its layout certainly risks becoming tired and drab in the eyes of the customer.

Report defective and out of date stock promptly

From time-to-time stock lines may become defective or out-of-date despite your best efforts to prevent this happening.

Frequent monitoring of stock for appearance and currency will help prevent or minimise the chance of this occurring.

It is vital when you notice a problem, or a potential problem, that you take appropriate action to remedy the problem. If you notice a problem, it is your responsibility to do something about it, even if this means just reporting the situation to management.

Regular housekeeping practices such as cleaning and wiping will also reduce the incidents of defective stock.

What is defective stock?

Defective stock may be items that are:

- Damaged in some way – they may be casks that have been crushed or dropped
- Bottles – especially wine bottles – with damaged or faded labels

- Sealed cartons that are torn or ripped open
- Four- and six-packs with damaged hand holds
- Products with broken seals
- Bottles with foreign objects floating in them
- Containers that have been short-filled
- Stock that has no Best Before advice, but which simply looks too old, too tired and unsaleable.



What should happen?

When you identify defective and out-of-date stock you are expected to report this situation to management.

The report should:

- Be made as soon as possible
- Identify the type of stock involved – brand names, size, style, vintage, etc.
- Quantify the products involved
- State where the products are.



It is also worthwhile making suggestions as to what could be done to 'clear' that stock. Clearing stock refers to moving the stock by either selling it at discount prices, returning it to a supplier, donating it to a local club with whom the premises has a business relationship or forwarding it to bars for dispense purposes.

Where stock is returned to suppliers, sold at a reduced price, donated, etc. there is usually a requirement to complete internal documents or stock control systems to reflect this.

An investigation should take place into why the defective stock or out-of-date stock situation arose in order for lessons to be learned and action can be taken to prevent recurrence of those situations.

Possible solutions to out-of-date stock can be:

- Re-vamping stock rotation protocols
- Buying less of that stock line – or quitting that line
- Establishing promotions and displays to assist in moving the items
- Developing more competitive pricing
- Re-locating the products to hot spots.



4.6 Prepare labels and tickets in accordance with enterprise procedures

Introduction

Most liquor stores will require staff to prepare promotional labels and price tickets for product lines.

These labels and tickets may be attached directly to products, attached to shelves or be part of displays. They can be attached to floor displays, be free-standing signs or signs that hang from the roof, or be stuck on windows, walls or doors.

Even where sales are processed using bar codes on stock and scanners at the register, there can still be a need to prepare these labels and tickets.

Background to preparing labels and tickets

Prices and hence labels and tickets, change as specials are introduced and finish, and as new lines are brought into the inventory.

This means labels and tickets are an essential selling tool which represent, in legal terms, an 'invitation to treat', and also function to add atmosphere to the store.

Some tickets and labels are hand-produced, some are electronically-generated and some may be supplied by head office or suppliers. The more professional they look the better.

Electronically-generated pricing tickets are quick to produce and re-produce as necessary, and provide a standardised and professional store-wide ticketing system.

Hand-writing a ticket, providing it is done neatly and presentably, provides for an immediacy of creation and allows instant changes to promotions, selling prices and advertising messages.



A labelling gun may be used to attach prices to individual stock items, and 'shelf talkers' can also be produced to give details of the product (brand name, quality, size, alcohol by volume content and price). Shelf talkers are positioned immediately below stock items and help by providing information to the consumer especially in relation to selling price, product quality and uses.

Accuracy and honesty is essential when creating these tickets and labels. If we put the wrong price, we are in trouble. If the stated price is higher than the advertised price, we will lose sales and customers will think we are ripping them off. If the price is too low, then we lose money. It's always a good idea to check the prices when you get a sudden and unexplained run on a certain line.

Also check your store policy in relation to incorrect prices – do they require you to sell at the incorrect advertised price? Or can you explain the error and charge the correct selling price?

Practical advice for preparing labels and tickets

Tips when preparing labels and tickets include:

- Be accurate and honest – make sure all descriptions are true and prices are correct
- Don't try to cram too much in to a label or ticket – the label shouldn't look 'too busy'
- Be selective about what you put in and what you leave out – trying to put too much information on a label is a common mistake for inexperienced people
- Make sure the label is clear, legible and readily understood – make sure it isn't ambiguous or unintentionally offensive. Customers have to be able to read and understand what is contained on the label or ticket. Follow the KISS principle (Keep It Simple, Stupid)
- Ensure it is the 'right' size – don't make it too big or it gets in the way, presents a hazard and reduces your ability to view the entire area. If it's too small people may have trouble reading it
- Construct it out of a suitable medium – choose something light yet robust and sturdy
- Make more than one of the same thing at the same time – tickets and labels get worn looking and scruffy so it is a good idea to have some spares wherever possible
- Check to ensure graphics or wording is in-keeping with images you are seeking to create for the store.



Enterprise procedures

Your workplace may have special requirements in relation to labels and tickets.

These may relate to:

- Who is authorised (or nominated) to produce labels and tickets
- Identification of words, phrases, etc. that cannot be used
- Certain logos, headers, etc. that must be included
- The locations where display materials can – and cannot – be physically located.



You are well-advised to look at the existing labels and tickets and use them as a guide for what you do.

What information might be included on display labels?

Check with your manager to identify exactly what information is required on your pricing tickets or display labels but it is usual for them to contain:

- Product name
- Supplier
- Stock control details – re-order quantities, maximum and minimum stock levels
- Size

- Selling price – including details of any special offers or options ('10% discount for 1 dozen lots', '25% off Recommended Retail Price') and indication of when special offers finish
- Various coded information such as stock identification code, bar code and date code.



Suppliers may also have various items to assist in the provision of further customer information. These may include tasting notes, food and beverage match-ups, weekly and monthly specials and order forms.

Remember to change labels when there is a change in the selling prices, when a promotion is finished, and when they look tired.

It is a good tip to obtain management approval for your first few hand-produced tickets or labels before putting them into the field.

Operate, maintain and store ticketing equipment

Ticketing equipment is expensive and essential.

Serious problems are created if this equipment is damaged as a result of incorrect use or if the basic preventative maintenance procedures are not carried out.

The two fundamentals are that:

- Ticketing equipment is operated according to manufacturer's instructions
- All enterprise policies regarding its use are followed – common policies relate to identification of who is authorised to use the equipment and the training they must receive.



What should I make sure I find out about?

Focus your attention on:

- Basic operating procedures – changing prices, altering dates, inputting description data, generating the actual ticket. Make sure you know where the instruction manuals are located
- Common problems and how to rectify them – with attention paid to the troubleshooting guide in the user manual
- Safety features – as appropriate
- Basic maintenance – including preventative maintenance and what to do if you identify a fault or experience a difficulty while using the equipment.

The three keys to learning how to operate any equipment are:

1. Read the manual – all of it, but especially the operational parts and the section on troubleshooting
2. Get some training – formal or via a 'buddy system', and this can include watching others who know what they are doing
3. Be supervised to obtain feedback – get an expert to watch you and suggest tips and strategies for improvement

Electronic bar coding equipment and price labelling equipment

This may include the computer-based creation of in-store bar codes or the use of labelling guns to produce and attach self-adhesive labels to stock and shelves.

The computer program for the bar codes will need to be followed to generate the elements and symbology character sets.

A bar code is really a machine-readable code. Different bar code printers will support various bar codes.

Alternatively, pre-printed bar code labels can be purchased from commercial suppliers, or supplied from Head Office.

While bar coding is extremely popular, there are many stores that still use other labelling methods such as label guns. These usually allow one or two information lines to be generated, containing a set number of characters that can be produced onto different shaped and coloured labels, including advisory labels such as sell by dates. Bar codes may also be produced this way.

Two categories of price-marking equipment

Price-marking equipment falls into two broad categories:

- Printers
- Pricing guns.



Printers

The first sort of printer includes bar code and label printers. These may be, and most commonly are, integrated with a personal computer, utilising a specific program.

The requirements for the labels are keyed into the computer and the program converts that data into the information required on the label. Labels can be purchased by the roll in a variety of colours, shapes and sizes, for example:

- Blank – which means they have nothing printed on them at all
- Partially pre-printed – meaning they can have headline information such as 'Special', 'Use by' or similar printed on them with extra room for you to add whatever date, details etc are required
- Fully pre-printed – suppliers usually ship within 24 hours of ordering and supply cartons of pre-printed rolls printed to your requirements.



The program for each printer will vary somewhat but usually includes a preview and a test print a number of labels before commencing a full run. Thermal labels should be chosen where the product is to be stored under cold conditions.

Loading labels or tags should be done following specific instructions for your printer, which may include directions such as the following which apply to the use of a thermal transfer printer:

- Remove media roll cover
- Separate paper guides
- Insert roll with label imaging surface facing print head

- Feed media roll as appropriate
- Lock guides into place
- Lift print-head and feed media roll under print-head and into paper exit
- Lower print-head, replace cover
- Press 'FEED' and wait for 'Ready' light to glow
- Run test.

Loading ribbon again must be done in strict accordance with manufacturer's instructions, with special attention to:

- Ensuring the dull/coated side of the ribbon is fitted the right way
- Notches and nibs are corresponding on the supply and take-up spindles.

There are some 'stand alone' label printers which are portable, and battery or electrically powered. These machines allow you to key the product details and information directly into the machine and generate the labels at the on the floor rather than in an office.

These items do not require connection to a personal computer.

Operating instructions for many printers are available as free downloads from many websites of suppliers, and some websites even supply free demonstration software.

Pricing guns

These are hand-held items used by staff to stick labels onto items on shelves etc.

Labels may be bought in or generated totally in-store.

Stores may use a combination of printers and hand-held labellers.

Operator instructions vary a little between labellers, but include:

- Selecting the information (known as 'variable data') to be printed on the labels – this is done via adjustable heads on the guns, which may feature 1, 2 or 3 heads, whereby dials are moved to select the appropriate alphanumeric requirements
- A set number of lines (1 – 3) with a limited number of characters per line may be chosen. This variable data may include bar code details but may also contain internal coding for batch numbers, etc.
- Inserting a roll of nominated labels
- Triggering the gun to move the label forward – this 'presents' the label ready for affixing, having removed it from its backing paper. Different adhesive types may be ordered to suit different labelling requirements. The backing strip is discarded to the rear of the gun
- Push the gun down towards the item to be labelled allowing the label to make contact with the desired surface, and draw back slightly with a smooth action visually checking that the label has attached as required.



4.7 Ensure stock is correctly priced

Introduction

Keeping all stock priced at the correct and current price is a necessity in all sales situations.

Failure to maintain correct pricing jeopardises profit and can cause negative customer relations.

Make sure you never share information to do with cost prices and how selling prices are calculated with members of the public or friends as it is deemed to be 'confidential' information.

The need for correct base information

Having ready access to all relevant base pricing information is a key requirement for charging the correct price, and showing the required returns on stock.



Pricing information may be provided to you by:

Suppliers

These are the wine and spirit wholesalers, breweries, soft drink companies and others that you deal with.

Most of these produce a monthly price list that reflects changes in prices over time and sets out full charges that are applicable for orders.

In some cases you may be subject to re-pack charges, insurance, delivery charges and others. It is only when you have all the details of all the charges that apply to each delivery that you can calculate the true in-store cost of any item.

Your selling price must be based on this knowledge so it needs to be complete, accurate and up-to-date.

Head office

Where you work in a store under the jurisdiction of a head office they may take care of all costings, pricing, and profit calculations.

Your store may never be required to try to work out costs prices and selling pricings because they are all done for you at head office and forwarded to you, usually via email.

Buying groups

If you belong to a buying group, they will determine the selling prices for you so as to ensure profitability, and an attractive price to tempt customers in through the door.

The selling prices they set may be store-wide or only on a selected range of products which vary from fortnight to fortnight or month to month.



Retaining pricing information

Information about costs and recommended prices is always filed away for future reference.

A filing system, usually referenced by supplier name, is the usual way to go, with old price lists being culled as new ones arrive.

Many suppliers will highlight products that have increased in cost since the previous catalogue so you can more readily note items requiring modification to their current selling price.

Conducting in-house checks

It can be a useful practice to do random checks on selling prices within the store to ensure:

- The required price is being shown on the label for the bottle
- The same price is listed on the shelf label
- The identical price is being shown on any other in-store advertising or promotional material
- The product registers the correct price when it is scanned
- The right price is being shown in any media advertising or flyers
- Where you have more than one outlet, that all outlets are displaying the same price
- The stated selling price is returning the required percentage mark up
- The stated selling price is in-line with head office requirements and buying group requirements.



Discounts

Many people are looking for a bargain when they buy their liquor and sometimes liquor outlets are prepared to offer discounts over and above the advertised specials.

Check with management to see what house rules apply in your store.

Often these discounts are not pro-actively offered or advertised - the customer has to ask for them.

It is possible that:

- A special price or discount is given if the customer buys an entire carton: this may apply to bottles of wine, slabs of beer, or cases of soft drink
- A special price may be available for beer that isn't chilled
- People who belong to certain local associations or clubs may obtain a discount simply by belonging to that group
- The organisation may have an in-house 'rewards' club that entitles members to a discount
- Some may accept and honour Senior Citizen's cards

- Purchases over a set dollar amount may attract a set sliding scale discount
- A special discount may apply to businesses that shop with us.

The possibilities for offering discounts, and the amount of discount offered, are virtually limitless. Remember those who receive discounts must be entitled to them. Giving discounts to those who don't qualify for them equates to theft.

The law

Stores using pricing tickets are under certain legal obligations, and required to comply with elements of fair trading legislation and also expected to comply with certain industry codes of practice.

Essentially the law requires any ticketing to be fair and accurate, to describe truthfully the product being offered for sale, and not to misrepresent the product in any way. For example, by claiming it is something other than what it actually is.



In addition, the product should only have one price ticket on it to avoid customer confusion.

Where there is more than one ticket, it is an offence to sell it for more than the lowest price but the item may be removed from sale.

You should also note that you are under no legal obligation to sell an item for its marked price, although it is quite obviously very poor business practice to do this on a regular basis.

This, however, protects you where a staff member has inadvertently marked a product at the wrong price (for example, the scotch is ticketed at \$3.99 for a 700ml bottle when it should have been \$33.99), and the customer is insisting you sell it at the advertised price.

The law says you are entitled to ask the normal price, and explain it was a mistake. The price on the item is regarded legally as an 'invitation to treat' (that is, an invitation for the buyer to make an offer to buy it), and is not regarded as an offer to sell.

Additionally your premises may be bound by a code of practice in relation to the scanning of selling prices. The code may state where the scanned price is more than the advertised shelf or other displayed price, you are required to refund the difference in price, to sell at the lowest price, or in the case of multiple purchases of the same item, to give the first one away and sell the rest at the lowest price.

Check with management to identify any other laws that apply in your premises and any other codes or agreements that are in force.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 4.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify steps associated with Receiving, unpacking and storing goods.
 - 4.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to explain how to display stock in an attractive manner.
 - 4.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to create and/or dismantle special promotional displays.
 - 4.4 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to keep displays clean and tidy.
 - 4.5 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to rotate stock.
 - 4.6 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to prepare labels and tickets.
 - 4.7 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to identify how to ensure stock is correctly priced.
-

Summary

Merchandise goods

Receive, unpack and store goods in appropriate location

- Where might stock need to be placed?
- Unpacking deliveries
- Customer service
- Practise safe lifting, shifting and handling procedures to comply with OSH regulations.

Display stock in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Display merchandise to achieve a balanced fully stocked appearance and promote sales
- Merchandising – shelves and displays
- Displays
- Merchandising
- An overview on displays.

Create and/or dismantle special promotional displays

- Re-setting a display
- Dismantling displays.

Keep displays clean and tidy

- Cleaning and tidying duties
- Ensure cleanliness of refrigerators and coolrooms
- Maintain the correct temperature of display refrigerators and coolrooms so that all products are kept at recommended temperatures.

Rotate stock in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Stock rotation principles
- Report defective and out of date stock promptly.

Prepare labels and tickets in accordance with enterprise procedures

- Background to preparing labels and tickets
- Practical advice for preparing labels and tickets
- Operate, maintain and store ticketing equipment.

Ensure stock is correctly priced

- The need for correct base information
- Retaining pricing information
- Discounts
- The law.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organized. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognize and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Johnston, R & Clark G, 2008 (3rd Edition); *Service Operations Management*; Pearson Education

Johnson, Hugh, 2007 (6th edition); *World Atlas of Wine*; MITCH

Katsigris, Costas, 2012 (5th edition); *The Bar and Beverage Book*; Wiley

Lillicrap, Dennis & Cousins, John, 2010 (1st edition); *Essential Food and Beverage Service: Levels 1 & 2*; Hodder Arnold

Regan, Gary, 2003 (1st edition); *The Joy of Mixology: The Consummate Guide to the Bartender's Craft*; Clarkson Potter

Robinson, Jancis, 2006 (3rd edition); *The Oxford Companion to Wine*; Oxford University Press

Robinson, Andrea, 2005 (2nd edition); *Great Wine Made Simple: Straight Talk from a Master Sommelier*; Clarkson Potter

Simon, Joanna & O'Leary, Ian, 2001 (1st edition); *Wine: An Introduction*; DK Adult

Walker, John R, 2008 (5th Edition); *Introduction to Hospitality*; Prentice Hall

Zeithaml, Valarie A, 2009 (1st edition); *Delivering Quality Service*; Free Press

Trainee evaluation sheet

Process liquor sales at a bar facility

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organized.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Process liquor sales at a bar facility

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Complete liquor sales			
1.1	Provide advice or information to customers on different types of products available	☐	☐
1.2	Process sales promptly in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
1.3	Complete order forms, invoices and/or receipts accurately in accordance with enterprise and legal requirements	☐	☐
1.4	Operate point of sale equipment in accordance with manufacturer's instructions	☐	☐
1.5	Ensure all necessary material and/or consumables are available at the point of sale area	☐	☐
1.6	Maintain cash drawer and float in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
1.7	Record transactions in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
1.8	Follow security procedures in accordance with enterprise requirements	☐	☐
Element 2: Pack goods			
2.1	Maintain adequate supplies of wrapping materials	☐	☐
2.2	Pack goods in a suitably sized bag or container that adequately protects the goods, or wrap goods neatly and effectively	☐	☐
2.3	Follow safe work practices while packing goods	☐	☐
Element 3: Minimise theft			
3.1	Apply security procedures to minimise theft	☐	☐
3.2	Maintain security of cash in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
3.3	Deal with suspicious behaviour of customers and/or staff in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
3.4	Keep storage areas secure from unauthorised access in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 4: Merchandise goods			
4.1	Receive, unpack and store goods in appropriate location	☐	☐
4.2	Display stock in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
4.3	Create and/or dismantle special promotional displays	☐	☐
4.4	Keep displays clean and tidy	☐	☐
4.5	Rotate stock in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
4.6	Prepare labels and tickets in accordance with enterprise procedures	☐	☐
4.7	Ensure stock is correctly priced	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

